

the hindu businessline

bl portfolio

bl interview.
Former SEBI board member Narayan offers a nuanced take on F&O, capital flows
BIGSTORY P2

Index outlook.
Benchmark indices are vulnerable to fall more after last week's sharp decline
CHARTGAZING P7

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

India forges BRICS consensus amid W. Asia split

RULE-BASED ORDER. Delhi Declaration condemns unilateral sanctions, backs WTO against protectionism, calls for Gaza aid access, lifting Cuba sanctions

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India pulled off a critical diplomatic balancing act at the BRICS Summit on Saturday, securing consensus among all 11 member-nations on a joint declaration that voices serious concern over the rise of “unilateral tariff and non-tariff measures” running contrary to WTO rules, and resolves to strengthen the multilateral trade body.

Negotiators worked through the night to bridge rifts between Iran and the UAE over the West Asia conflict to arrive at language acceptable to all, sources close to the development said.

CONDEMNS COERCION

The resulting New Delhi Declaration condemns unilateral coercive measures as violations of international law, calls for protecting global trade, energy flows and supply chains, demands an end to the blockade against Cuba, and voices concern over the escalating tensions in West Asia — all the while avoiding direct mention of specific countries.

On trade, the Declaration is unambiguous: “The proliferation of trade-restrictive actions that are inconsistent with WTO rules, whether in the form of indiscriminate



UNITED FRONT. Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping and Russian President Vladimir Putin at the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on Saturday. ANI

inate rising of tariffs and non-tariff measures, or protectionism under the guise of environmental objectives, threatens to further reduce global trade, disrupt global supply chains, and introduce uncertainty into interna-

tional economic and trade activities, potentially exacerbating existing economic disparities and negatively affecting prospects for global economic development.”

The language is an indirect reference to the wave of tariffs im-

posed by the Donald Trump administration over the past two years and Europe's green trade restrictions, both of which have rattled several BRICS economies.

BRICS leaders resolved to work together to make the WTO

more responsive to trade disruptions and the needs of emerging markets, and renewed their push for restoring a fully functioning, two-tier WTO dispute settlement mechanism — whose top appellate body has remained paralysed for years — calling for new Appellate Body members to be appointed “without further delay.”

THREAT TO HUMAN RIGHTS

On coercive measures, the Declaration notes that sanctions and secondary sanctions imposed unilaterally, inflict far-reaching harm on the human rights of ordinary citizens in targeted states — from healthcare and food security to development — while disproportionately hurting the poor. The bloc called for the elimination of such measures altogether, reaffirming its opposition to sanctions that lack UN Security Council authorisation.

The Declaration also takes up Cuba's case as part of its broader critique of unilateral sanctions. BRICS leaders expressed deep concern over the tightening of unilateral blockade measures against Cuba, citing their adverse effects on the Cuban economy, energy supplies and the humanitarian situation on the island. The bloc reiterated the need to end the sanctions, in line with a UNGA resolution.

In the declaration, China and Russia reiterated their support for India and Brazil's “aspirations” to play a greater role in the UN Security Council.

On the West Asia crisis, negotiators crafted careful language expressing deep concern over the continued escalation of tensions in the region, urging all sides to exercise maximum restraint. “We stress the need to work together to maintain smooth flow of global trade, supply chains and energy, in accordance with applicable international law,” the declaration said, explicitly tying the security crisis to trade — alluding to the disruption the Iran-Israel-US conflict has caused to Gulf shipping and oil markets.

GAZA VIOLENCE ALARM

BRICS leaders also expressed deep concern over the ongoing violence in Gaza despite the October 2025 ceasefire and called for unhindered humanitarian access and an immediate halt to any policies aimed at the forced displacement of Palestinians. The bloc urged implementation of relevant UNSC and UNGA resolutions, cautioning against arrangements that could legitimise or prolong the occupation and prejudice the inalienable rights of the Palestinian people.

More reports p11

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

ESDS Software Solution: Book profit

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

The *bl portfolio* edition dated August 30, 2026 had recommended that investors with high-risk appetite subscribe to the IPO of IT infrastructure services provider ESDS Software Solution.

The long-term view was based on fundamentals, but since listing, many years of gains have been realised in just six trading sessions, and investors can book profit in ESDS shares after the extraordinary post-listing rally.

At ₹1,716.35 (BSE), the stock is trading at about four times its ₹429 issue price, valuing FY26 earnings at roughly 166 times versus 41.6 times at the IPO price.

The market-capitalisation has also surged from around ₹5,000 crore to over ₹20,000 crore.

The business remains attractive, but expectations have run far ahead of demonstrated earnings, making profit-booking prudent after the sharp rally.

Details p5

Modi-Xi talks: Border peace, trade imbalance correction ‘central to India-China reset’

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India made peace and tranquillity along the border and correction of the structural trade imbalance with China central to the further development of bilateral ties, as Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping met, on Saturday for the first time since the 2020 Galwan clashes.

At their talks on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi — Xi's first visit to India in seven years — the two leaders committed to a “fair, reasonable and mutually acceptable” resolution of the boundary question and agreed to address each other's concerns on trade, including the widen-

ing imbalance, supply-chain issues and the need for meaningful and predictable market access.

“Prime Minister emphasised that peace and tranquillity in the border areas remains an essential basis for the continued development of bilateral relations. He underlined the need for both sides to observe existing agreements and understandings on border related issues,” according to a statement issued by the Ministry of External Affairs post the meeting between the two leaders.

FRAGILE THAW

The Modi-Xi talks were crucial as they centred on the fragile thaw in bilateral relations following the 2020 military standoff along the



TALKING PEACE. PM Narendra Modi during a bilateral meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping on Saturday. PTI

Line of Actual Control (LAC).

While both nations have made diplomatic and military strides to stabilise ties and restore periodic high-level exchanges, underlying friction continues to obstruct deeper economic engagement.

Despite an eight-point

consensus arrived recently at the meeting of the National Security Advisor, Ajit Doval, and China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi at the Special Representatives' talks in Beijing on August 25, further discussions have yielded little progress, a source tracking the matter said.

“Beijing has been pushing

for a further easing of investment restrictions on Chinese companies, but New Delhi wants greater peace at the borders before making substantial commitments,” the source added.

India's major concerns on the rising trade deficit with China and various restrictions placed by Beijing affecting India's supply chains, such as export curbs on rare-earth elements and critical machinery, were also taken up at the meeting.

“On economic and trade relations, they underlined the need to address each other's concerns, including structural trade imbalance and supply chain issues, and facilitation of meaningful and predictable market access,” the MEA statement highlighted.

SEBI proposes new timings for closing auction and derivatives settlement

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed changes to the closing auction session (CAS), including two methodologies to determine the settlement price for derivatives on expiry days, shortening the transition period during the auction and removing the indicative index value.

The regulator has proposed settling prices for index and single-stock derivatives on expiry days either through a blended volume-weighted average price (VWAP) method using trades in the last 30 minutes of continuous trading and 10 minutes of CAS, or temporarily going back to the VWAP-based methodology

for at least a year.

The tweaks come over a month after the introduction of CAS on August 3, which moved away from VWAP method to an auction

There are two alternatives for market timings as well.

CONTINUOUS TRADING

One option allows continuous trading in CAS stocks until 3.30 pm, followed by the auction, with derivatives trading continuing till 3.45 pm.

Or, retaining the existing 3.15 pm cut-off for continuous trading in CAS stocks, while derivatives trading will end at 3.30 pm.

In both cases, there will be a cut in the transition period between continuous trading and CAS to a minute from five minutes, and the post-CAS derivatives window

from 10 minutes to five.

SEBI has also proposed that exchanges stop disseminating the indicative index value during CAS to avoid misinterpretation of such index values as an actual traded value, while continuing to provide indicative equilibrium prices for individual stocks.

REFERENCE PRICE

It has suggested restricting cancellation of orders placed more than 1 per cent away from the reference price, while allowing price-improving modifications.

Unexecuted Iceberg orders at the start of CAS could also be converted into normal limit orders with full disclosure.

SEBI has invited public comments on the proposals until October 3.

Pezeshkian meets UAE leadership in BRICS Summit diplomacy

Our Bureau
New Delhi

In a significant diplomatic breakthrough, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian held a meeting with Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khalid bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit on Saturday.

“Masoud Pezeshkian, President of the Islamic Republic of Iran, held a meeting and talks with Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, President of the United Arab Emirates, on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit,” Iran's Embassy in Delhi said in a post.

ATTACKS CONDEMNED

Pezeshkian, who met religious leaders in Delhi besides having a bilateral meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Presid-



Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian PTI

ent Droupadi Murmu as also other BRICS delegates, used the platform to strongly condemn use of some territories to launch attacks on neighbours, a reference to the US's use of Gulf states for its defence bases and mounting strikes on Iran.

“Sustainable security depends on full respect for national sovereignty and rejecting the model of security for some and insecurity for others. Preventing the mis-

use of countries' territories to threaten their neighbours is an inviolable principle. BRICS must stand against normalisation of attacks on civilian infrastructure and peaceful nuclear facilities,” Pezeshkian told the BRICS delegates.

US-ISRAELI OFFENSIVE

The BRICS developments assume importance in the context of Iran's multiple strikes on Abu Dhabi that hosts US Air Force's 380th Air Expeditionary Wing and the Al Dhafra Base among others, following the US-Israeli offensive against Iran.

Abu Dhabi has repeatedly called the attacks a “flagrant violation of national sovereignty” and, alongside five other Gulf states, issued a joint condemnation of Iran; the UAE also revoked residency permits for Iranian nationals and shut Iranian schools.

HDFC Bank shortlists ‘2 candidates’ for top post

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Fast-tracking the process for selection and appointment of Sashidhar Jagdishan's successor, the HDFC Bank board on Saturday shortlisted ‘two candidates’, whose names will be submitted to the RBI so that it can approve one to occupy the top position at the bank for three years.

While the bank did not disclose the names of the prospective candidates, market players say they could be Paresh Sukthankar, former Deputy Managing Director, HDFC Bank; K Balasubramanian, Citi's Chief Country Officer for India; Vishaka Mulye, Chief Executive Officer of Aditya Birla Capital; and Vibha Padalkar, CEO and MD of HDFC Life.

The board also took other important decisions such as the creation of an

additional position of a Whole-Time Director (WTD) to have a larger pipeline for succession planning; appointment of Jimmy Tata (currently Chief Credit Officer) as a WTD (designated an Executive Director); and re-appointment of V Srinivasa Rangan as a WTD (designated as an ED).

RBI APPROVAL

These decisions, based on the recommendations of Governance, Nomination and Remuneration Committee and pursuant to the Banking Regulation Act, 1949 and the Reserve Bank of India (Commercial Banks — Governance) Directions, 2025, are being submitted to the RBI for its approval, HDFC Bank said in a regulatory filing. The board's move to find a replacement for Jagdishan follows his decision to not seek his reappointment as the MD & CEO of the bank.

Listing pressure up on Tata Sons as RBI rejects its CIC de-registration bid

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Tata Sons Private Ltd will have to soon draw up plans to get listed on the bourses as its bid for de-registration as a core investment company (CIC) has been rejected by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

Rejection of Tata Sons application for de-registration as a CIC implies that it will continue to be in the list of Non-Banking Finance Companies in the Upper Layer (NBFC-UL), requiring it to list.

The RBI NBFC-UL list, released on August 6, had 17 NBFCs, including Tata Sons Pvt Ltd. Then the central bank said inclusion of Tata Sons in the list of NBFC-UL is without prejudice to the outcome of its application for de-registration, which is under examination.

This development comes



Noel Tata

amid Noel Tata's bid to stamp his authority on Tata Sons via Tata Trusts and N Chandrasekaran's mid-August decision to step down as the Chairman of Tata Sons when his current term ends in February 2027.

LISTING DIVIDE

“The issue of listing Tata Sons has divided its key shareholders. Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata is in favour of keeping the group holding company private.

“Tata Trusts control over 66 per cent of shares in Tata Sons and listing them would bring the holding company under greater scrutiny,” said sources. The Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) Group, which owns about 18 per cent stake in Tata Sons, supports the listing of shares as a way to unlock liquidity.

There have been discussions between SP group and Noel Tata on various ways to monetise the shares. As per reports, various proposals are under consideration including a buyback or offering SP Group shares in listed Tata Group companies.

Tata Sons was also in the first list of NBFC-UL released by the RBI in October 2022. As per the NBFC-UL framework, an entity has to get listed within three years of its name appearing in the list. An email sent to the RBI seeking confirmation remained unanswered at press time.

bl.interview

Hari Viswanath
bl. Research Bureau

Trader, academic, advisor, and regulator — Ananth Narayan Gopalakrishnan has established a versatile career spanning over 30 years in the financial sector. While his domain expertise covers global macro trading and public policy, his recent tenure as a Whole-Time Member of SEBI was particularly noted for its focus on market integrity and transparency. During his tenure at SEBI, he oversaw critical actions, including the detailed public disclosure regarding the Jane Street trading probe and the publication of comprehensive data highlighting the financial risks faced by retail investors in the F&O segment. While there are quite a few like him who know market plumbing inside out, there are fewer like him with the ability to explain these complex concepts in a lucid way that anyone can grasp. Speaking to *businessline*, he shares his current perspectives on many aspects relating to financial markets and the economy today. *Excerpts:*

Let us start with the F&O market, which is the elephant in the room. During your tenure at SEBI, you initiated the transparent publication of data on retail investors' losses, making it part of the mainstream debate. Yet, nearly 90 per cent of retail traders continue to lose money every year, with annual losses of around ₹1 lakh crore. F&O notional volumes are also 300-400 times cash-market volumes on a monthly basis, raising concerns about excessive speculation and market manipulation. Isn't it time for some stronger regulatory action?

On F&O, let me start with the larger picture. Derivative markets, including speculation, play a crucial role in price discovery, market depth and providing hedging mechanisms to market participants.

That said, SEBI identified three distinct concerns around the state of our F&O market, starting with its first consultation paper around July 2024.

The first was investor protection. As you point out, around 90 per cent of individual traders were losing money, and the number remains exceptionally high. When around one crore individuals participate in a market where nine out of ten lose money, with an average loss of around ₹1.2 lakh per individual, that must concern a regulator whose primary mandate is investor protection.

The second concern was market integrity and stability around index-option expiry days. On some expiry days, equivalent volumes in index options were 700-800 times the volumes in the underlying cash market.

More strikingly, market-wide open interest in index options continued to increase right up to around 3:15 p.m. on expiry day. Imagine an extreme external shock occurring at 3:15 p.m. on such a day, with derivative exposures many hundreds of times the underlying cash-market volumes. The potential spillovers could be significant and pose risks to market stability.

There was also a market-integrity concern, given the settlement outcome of a very large derivatives market is determined by prices in a much smaller underlying market. There are some parallels with the vulnerabilities that became apparent in the LIBOR rate-setting scandal.

The third concern was the extremely short tenure of our F&O contracts. A healthy derivatives market ideally has substantial activity in contracts extending beyond a month, consistent with their role in both trading and hedging.

In India, activity had become overwhelmingly concentrated in very short-dated contracts, particularly weekly index options. On expiry day, these effectively become zero-day-to-expiry, or ODTE, options.

Research suggests that ODTE options can, under certain circumstances, amplify rather than dampen intra-day volatility.

‘It is important to allow markets to give their natural signal’

NUANCED TAKE. Ananth Narayan decodes the blind side of F&O excesses, market interventions and more

So during your tenure at SEBI and now, why was/is there hesitancy for stronger measures like banning weekly options?

Because there was another side to the argument that SEBI had to consider. Markets are complex, and regulators must be careful about large interventions, particularly in markets involving willing buyers and sellers. Even actions taken with the best intentions can have unintended consequences. Unless there is a serious market failure requiring immediate action, there is merit in proceeding thoughtfully, based on data and consultation.

There was also a practical consideration. Exchanges, clearing corporations and brokers derived a significant proportion of their revenues from derivatives, particularly index options. A drastic intervention could therefore have produced a substantial shock across an interconnected market ecosystem. The objective was not to protect those revenues. The concern was what such a shock might do to liquidity, market-making, the cash market and the sentiment in the wider ecosystem.

That is why SEBI chose a calibrated approach. The first consultation paper was issued in July 2024, followed by extensive and candid discussions with market participants. Those consultations were substantive, not procedural. Several of the suggestions and concerns raised by stakeholders were incorporated into the final measures introduced in October 2024. These measures, among other things, sharply reduced the number of weekly index-option expiries.

We then assessed the impact of those measures before issuing another consultation paper in February 2025, aimed at further reducing the risks of manipulation and market instability. Again, the consultation process resulted in useful inputs and modifications, many of which were reflected in the final measures implemented in May 2025. So, the approach was deliberately data-driven, consultative and incremental. I believe that was the appropriate approach.

The latest SEBI research, however, shows that some of the concerns we were grappling with have not disappeared. That does not automatically tell us what the regulatory response should be. But it does suggest that the issue merits renewed deliberation.

The appropriate approach, in my view, is the same one as before: examine the new evidence carefully, assess the impact of the measures already taken, consult stakeholders and experts, and then consider whether any further measures are warranted.

What would be your suggestions now?

I would put a few ideas on the table for discussion rather than prescribe any single solution.

First, the latest SEBI research suggests some moderation in individual participation but also shows that a significant proportion of those losing money in F&O have little or no underlying equity holdings. Many enter by buying options for relatively small amounts and trying to exit quickly at a profit.

This raises questions of suitability

and appropriateness. Several jurisdictions have safeguards to ensure that those trading complex derivatives understand the risks and have the financial capacity to bear losses. India already has such requirements; there may be merit in examining whether they need to be strengthened.

In this context, there is a broader institutional issue. Exchanges, clearing corporations and depositories perform important quasi-regulatory functions, but are also competing commercial entities. There is merit in debating whether some regulatory and market-wide risk-management functions should eventually be housed in a separate, not-for-profit entity, insulating them more clearly from commercial considerations.

Second, we should try to deepen the underlying cash market. Strengthening the Securities Lending and Borrowing Mechanism, which facilitates short-selling, arbitrage and market-making, is worth debating.

Third, if we want to encourage longer-tenure derivatives, we should examine whether margin requirements can be rationalized for such contracts, particularly for spread and basis trades where the underlying economic risk can be considerably lower.

Moving to another topic you have extensively spoken about – the FCNR (B) swap scheme. The RBI is subsidising the cost to an extent, at the same time it can earn interest from the dollars it invests in the US Treasury. Yet, it will have to incur costs due to OMOs to remove some excess liquidity in the system. How to assess the net cost to system because of this?

Let us look at the broader context. In FY26, to facilitate monetary-policy transmission, support credit growth and address tight banking liquidity, the RBI purchased ₹8.8 lakh crore of government securities through OMOs — equivalent to around 84 per cent of the Centre's net market borrowing. This brought down yields sharply, but also had consequences for savings, capital flows and the rupee. With yields low, domestic savings increasingly flowed into equities even as banks struggled to attract term deposits. Meanwhile, amid pockets of high equity valuations, net foreign portfolio flows into equities remained weak.

More importantly, narrow interest-rate differentials between India and global markets made it cheaper to buy dollars forward. This encourages hedgers and speculators to buy rather than sell dollars forward. Lower relative returns in India also encouraged HNIs to look for opportunities overseas.

Across FY25 and FY26, the RBI sold around \$192 billion in the spot and forward FX markets. By my estimates, only around \$75 billion can be explained by the current-account deficit and net FDI and FPI flows. Much of the remaining roughly \$117 billion appears to reflect hedging and other financial demand for dollars, encouraged by narrow interest-rate differentials.

These forces can become self-reinforcing: dollar buying weakens

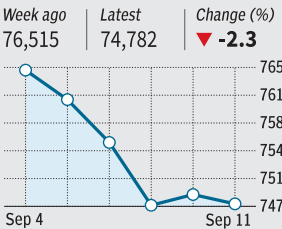
WISE WORDS.

“The ability to borrow enormous amounts of money combined with a chance to get either very rich or very poor very quickly has historically been a recipe for trouble at some point.

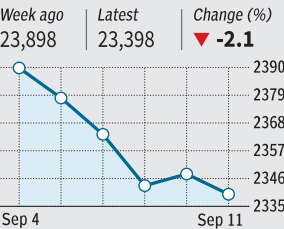
WARREN BUFFETT
on derivatives

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



● PROFILE

Ananth Narayan served as a Whole-Time Member of SEBI from 2022 to 2025, overseeing market infrastructure, secondary markets and enforcement. Earlier, he was Associate Professor at Bhavan's SPJIMR and served on the boards of SBI Capital Markets, Yes Bank, Care Ratings and NSE Clearing. He previously spent 25 years in global financial markets with Standard Chartered, Deutsche Bank and Citibank.

the rupee, which can generate expectations of further depreciation and additional dollar buying. The rupee consequently depreciated rapidly, reaching around 92.5 by February, even before the Iran situation emerged.

It was against this backdrop that the RBI introduced the FCNR(B) swap facility. At the time, the five-year market swap rate was around 3 per cent per annum. Put simply, if the spot dollar was ₹95, the five-year forward rate would have been around ₹110. Instead, under the facility, the RBI effectively offered to sell the dollars back after five years at ₹95 — at zero forward premium. Relative to market pricing, this represented an economic concession of around 3 per cent annually, or roughly 15 per cent over five years. On the roughly \$127 billion of five-year FCNR(B) deposits, I estimate its present value at around \$14-15 billion.

That value is being realized across three sets of participants. NRIs are earning dollar returns of around 6-6.25 per cent, substantially higher than before the facility, and potentially much higher through leverage. Foreign banks providing such leverage earn a spread over their funding costs. Indian banks receive five-year INR funding at around 6.5 per cent, without SLR, CRR or priority-sector-lending requirements, which they can deploy profitably, including into government securities.

So, if participants are realising a substantial economic benefit from the concession, there must be a corresponding direct or indirect economic cost somewhere in the system. There is no free lunch.

Exactly. So who is bearing this cost?

The direct and indirect costs are likely to be diffused across the system and in different forms. Much depends considerably on what the RBI does with the dollars it receives and the corresponding rupee liquidity. If the RBI retains and invests the dollars, the rupee liquidity may need to be absorbed. If it uses Variable Rate Reverse Repos, there is a rupee interest cost. If it sells some of its government

bonds, there is an opportunity cost. If the Market Stabilization Scheme is used, the Government bears the interest cost; if CRR is increased, banks bear an opportunity cost. Alternatively, the RBI could sell some of the dollars and buy them back forward at market rates, in which case the cost of the zero-premium swap becomes more explicit. It could also sell the dollars outright in the spot market. But since it has committed to returning dollars to the banks five years later, that would leave the RBI with an open foreign-exchange exposure and therefore some currency risk. In practice, we are likely to see some combination of these approaches over the five-year period.

Overall it is best seen as a direct and indirect economic cost of an intervention designed to achieve broader monetary and foreign-exchange objectives. The relevant question is whether those benefits justify the concession and its direct and indirect costs. That assessment can only really be made over time.

There is also an important consequence. Banks have received a very large pool of five-year rupee funding at around 6.5 per cent. Without this, they would presumably have had to compete more aggressively for domestic deposits. The facility could therefore keep deposit and other rupee interest rates lower than they might otherwise have been, with domestic savers bearing some of the opportunity cost.

There has been an excessive focus on FPI taxation as a key reason for outflows, when in effect, other factors such as elevated equity valuations in India and rising global bond yields have been the driving factors. With US 10-year yields near 5 per cent, what is your outlook for FPI inflows into India?

Agree that we should not attribute FPI outflows simply to taxation. Global investors look at expected returns after adjusting for growth prospects, valuations, interest rates, currency risk and taxes. When US Treasury yields are close to 5 per cent, the hurdle rate for investing elsewhere naturally rises. If Indian equities are relatively expensive and the rupee is under pressure, that hurdle rises further. That said, addressing FPI taxation is one area where we can improve our competitiveness.

There is a related domestic issue. Comparable financial assets receive very different tax treatment. Debt is disadvantaged relative to equity, while interest is taxed at marginal rates even though part of the nominal interest merely compensates savers for inflation. For domestic savers, taxation should be reasonably low and neutral between comparable financial assets. Investment decisions should primarily reflect risk and return, not tax arbitrage. This combined with financial repression has had the unintended consequence of pushing up equity valuations which has the unintended consequence of keeping out both net FPI and FDI.

How do we fix this systemic distortion?

My preference is for less distortion

of the price of money. It is important to allow markets to give their natural signal. The RBI's ₹8.8 lakh crore of bond purchases in FY26 helped lower long-term yields substantially. There were valid monetary-policy and liquidity objectives behind those interventions, but such large interventions also affect savings allocation, capital flows and the currency. Over time, I would prefer greater market determination of interest rates, combined with a tax regime that does not disadvantage fixed-income savings, while keeping rates low for our borrowers. That would address the underlying distortions more directly.

What is your view about de-dollarisation? The US debt is at \$40 trillion and debt/GDP ratio at 120 per cent. Politicians there don't seem to be taking it seriously. Are alternatives to the dollar emerging? If not, how do you think it is likely to play out?

At least so far, the data do not suggest that another fiat currency is in a position to replace the US dollar. The BIS triennial survey continues to show the dollar on one side of close to 90 per cent of global foreign-exchange transactions. The euro is a distant second, and the renminbi and other currencies remain much smaller. There is an important distinction, however, between the dollar losing some of its dominance and the dollar being replaced. The former is already happening at the margin; the latter is much harder to envisage.

The US clearly has serious fiscal challenges. But the uncomfortable reality is that no other major currency has yet emerged as a more credible alternative at sufficient scale, with the combination of deep and liquid financial markets, convertibility, institutional credibility and rule of law that a global reserve currency requires.

What we are seeing instead is diversification. Central banks have gradually reduced the dollar's share in their reserves, while increasing allocations to gold and, to a lesser extent, other currencies. Geopolitical tensions, trade conflicts and the demonstrated possibility of foreign reserves being frozen have added to the incentive to diversify.

That matters for the US Treasury market. If some traditional official buyers become less willing to absorb incremental US debt, that debt has to find other buyers. Private investors will buy it, but they will demand an appropriate return, particularly when US fiscal deficits are large, Treasury issuance is heavy, and there is competing demand for capital from the private sector, including the enormous investment requirements of AI and hyperscalers.

The recent rise in US Treasury yields is therefore a warning signal. My hope is that a 10-year yield around 5 per cent helps bring fiscal sustainability back into the political debate.

Sometimes markets impose discipline where politics has postponed difficult choices. But there is a risk that things get worse before they get better. A sustained rise in US long-term yields can transmit stress across virtually every major financial market in the world.

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 2.3 and 2.1 per cent respectively last week. BSE Healthcare gained the most by 0.6 per cent, followed by BSE Power 0.3 per cent. BSE Realty and BSE IT declined by 6.5 and 5.4 per cent respectively last week.

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr.High	Yr.Low
360 ONE [1]	1092.2	31.0	35.3	4.8	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	-3.9	12.1	1.6	1235.7	996.2
3M India [1]	32664.5	391.4	83.5	20.8	202606	19.0	-0.4	15.7	-11.2	-0.7	47.3	0.1	38300.0	28747.3

A B B [2]	7269.1	72.7	99.9	16.5	202606	21.0	8.0	10.0	-13.0	-2.0	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5
A Lifestyle	83.4	1.7	17.7	2.7	202606	11.1	20.6	9.1	31.5	-2.9	12.5	2.2	150.8	88.6
A B Real Estate	1284.7	-29.2	3.9	3.9	202606	30.4	-255.2	-55.7	-267.7	-6.4	-4.1	1.4	1974.5	1080.1
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	456.4	26.3	17.3	2.7	202606	17.1	19.0	17.7	21.5	5.6	11.3	2.5	563.0	42.5
Aarti Industries [5]	4592.2	14.4	34.2	3.0	202606	42.5	256.5	27.0	112.2	0.1	6.9	0.8	551.5	338.2
Aarti Industries [5]	1275.1	61.9	20.6	2.7	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	-2.2	9.9	3.2	1775.0	150.4
Abbott India	25586.1	759.9	33.7	11.4	202606	4.3	17.1	6.3	11.2	-1.9	43.8	0.031495	92514.0	740.5
ACC	1246.2	101.2	12.3	1.1	202606	4.6	-56.3	11.5	18.6	-2.9	11.2	0.0	1986.9	1232.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	401.9	8.4	47.7	3.6	202606	67.8	64.8	47.5	45.4	-3.9	7.4	2.8	430.4	19.5
Action Const.Eng. [2]	1129.4	36.7	30.8	6.7	202606	20.5	22.3	5.2	3.3	0.3	0.1	0.0	1195.8	74.6
Acutacs Chemical [5]	3377.4	47.2	71.6	16.7	202606	59.1	67.7	40.9	104.3	6.7	32.2	0.0	3735.0	1290.1
Adani Energy Sol.	1373.8	23.9	57.6	5.8	202606	4.2	124.2	20.9	21.8	-2.6	9.5	1.9	1789.0	804.7
Adani Enterp. [1]	3057.1	19.0	160.8	4.4	202606	49.9	14.9	18.1	28.8	4.1	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1753.5
Adani Consl.Eng. [2]	1282.0	11.9	107.3	11.0	202606	15.6	16.6	7.2	1.0	-1.4	8.0	5.7	1631.4	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1765.0	57.7	30.6	4.2	202606	18.6	9.2	23.8	16.8	3.3	13.8	0.7	1891.8	1293.1
Adani Power [2]	209.9	7.4	28.4	6.5	202606	30.4	42.0	6.6	14.9	1.4	16.6	0.8	254.2	120.5
Adani Total Gas [1]	594.8	5.7	103.5	13.5	202606	27.2	14.2	19.8	-2.4	-2.9	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	110.1	34.9	31.5	1.7	202606	3.5	11.7	6.6	3.9	3.2	0.0	0.0	122.4	70.8
Aditya Birl. F&S.	50.4	-6.1		1.1	202606	10.6	-201.5	11.4	-1.4	-4.7	0.0	0.9	95.0	49.4
Aditya Birla Cap.	398.6	14.7	27.1	2.8	202606	28.2	40.1	16.3	18.2	-1.5	8.8	4.9	430.6	278.1
Aditya Infotech [1]	3830.2	40.3	94.9	24.1	202606	89.5	332.5	51.8	214.8	3.4	28.1	0.3	4094.5	1228.9
Aegis Logistics [1]	1353.1	35.6	38.0	7.8	202606	37.1	268.9	30.4	88.7	6.5	16.1	0.8	1498.0	570.8
Aegis Vopak Term	294.9	2.4	120.6	9.6	202606	12.4	-7.0	26.1	42.9	3.6	8.7	1.9	311.5	158.8
Aether Infrastr.	1673.0	18.1	92.5	9.0	202606	27.2	28.0	34.4	30.4	2.9	11.6	0.1	1716.3	723.2
Afcons Industry.	254.0	5.6	45.6	1.7	202606	-20.8	-77.7	-11.9	-61.5	-13.2	10.5	0.6	47.9	24.1
Airtel [3]	1253.2	10.5	121.0	7.8	202606	21.5	18.0	21.1	19.8	30.3	-3.1	16.7	122.0	79.8
AIA Engineering [2]	492.9	136.0	30.1	3.3	202606	12.4	-1.3	5.5	14.7	3.3	0.0	0.0	5175.0	3001.9
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3540.0	98.0	39.0	9.8	202606	4.8	30.9	20.2	22.0	2.0	19.8	0.7	3797.0	2335.0
Allkem Lab. [2]	5089.5	190.6	26.7	4.4	202606	10.9	-20.5	13.4	0.2	-2.0	19.7	0.1	5933.0	3528.7
Alkermid Randers [2]	631.9	8.0	79.2	10.6	202606	6.1	30.0	8.4	-7.1	3.6	18.3	0.6	720.0	382.7
Alkem Industries [1]	240.4	1.5	12.2	2.0	202606	-2.5	-178.8	1.9	-1.7	0.0	0.0	19.3	0.0	11.2
Amar Raja Ener. [1]	814.1	39.9	20.4	1.8	202606	23.9	15.9	12.7	-6.9	-5.8	11.7	0.0	1058.0	671.5
Amar Entbter.	7237.2	56.1	129.0	5.8	202606	12.7	-3.4	14.6	-28.1	-3.5	10.6	0.7	8970.0	540.4
Ambuja Cements [2]	191.0	19.2	20.4	1.6	202606	27.7	-29.1	-7.1	5.7	-5.6	6.7	0.0	600.8	387.8
Anand Rathn. Wea. [2]	228.4	18.0	12.9	36.8	202606	21.5	32.8	22.7	45.2	2.8	9.8	0.1	225.9	29.8
Anant Raj [2]	599.1	16.1	37.3	3.7	202606	6.6	18.9	17.0	25.7	-4.1	12.0	0.1	744.1	403.5
Angel One [1]	305.0	11.3	27.6	4.6	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	2.3	14.8	0.1	360.2	208.9
Anthem Bioscienc [2]	942.3	10.5	89.5	17.4	202606	-22.6	-11.7	-2.1	17.6	0.9	29.3	0.0	977.0	579.5
Anu Indus [2]	1738.2	78.0	19.8	9.3	202606	21.0	32.0	28.0	36.7	6.5	16.1	0.8	1498.0	570.8
APR Indus.	17496.2	287.9	60.8	9.3	202606	29.2	77.8	24.0	36.7	0.5	31.1	0.2	18432.4	6800.8
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	2153.0	44.3	48.6	11.3	202606	8.7	10.9	10.6	53.4	-4.3	30.6	0.1	2300.9	1653.4
Apollo Hospitals [5]	8850.0	146.3	60.5	13.4	202606	20.6	34.2	17.2	33.7	2.1	18.1	0.7	9326.8	6868.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	417.6	33.6	12.4	1.6	202606	12.8	0.1	11.2	72.5	-2.8	13.4	0.3	540.3	365.4
Apna Value Hold. [2]	258.4	18.0	14.3	1.6	202606	21.5	32.8	22.7	45.2	2.8	9.8	0.1	225.9	29.8
Asahi India Glas [1]	985.2	17.5	56.3	6.4	202606	14.2	165.4	9.3	37.0	-3.1	11.2	0.7	1073.0	775.1
Ashok Leyland [1]	164.0	6.4	25.8	6.8	202606	11.7	0.8	16.4	17.1	-3.6	13.8	0.3	215.4	132.2
Asian Paints [1]	2470.0	50.9	48.6	11.1	202606	17.9	40.0	9.9	26.7	-2.3	25.9	0.2	2855.5	2116.0
Aspirin Pharma [2]	763.0	17.9	43.0	2.4	202606	21.5	32.8	22.7	45.2	2.8	9.8	0.1	225.9	29.8
Astral [1]	141.01	22.1	63.9	9.3	202606	15.9	48.2	16.8	22.3	-6.3	19.4	0.1	1768.0	1331.7
Ather Energy [1]	1655.5	-9.7	16.1	202606	88.8	-128.5	67.2	52.4	4.5	0.0	0.4	174.1	530.9	
Atul	6244.6	270.2	23.1	3.0	202606	25.0	92.0	15.8	59.1	-2.2	14.9	0.0	7196.2	5563.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1675.5	65.7	25.5	2.5	202606	16.9	28.1	9.4	11.5	1.3	12.4	0.2	1706.7	1060.1
Authum Invest [1]	546.7	24.7	22.1	3.2	202606	20.9	17.8	-34.6	-48.7	5.4	13.6	0.2	683.5	400.8
Avenue Super.	3687.9	46.9	78.7	9.8	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	-2.2	17.2	0.1	4815.9	3528.7
Avanir Busines. [1]	281.2	1.5	12.2	2.0	202606	-2.5	-178.8	1.9	-1.7	0.0	0.0	19.3	0.0	11.2
Axis Bank [2]	1247.5	89.2	14.0	1.8	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	-2.0	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1068.2

B H E L [2]	430.6	7.0	61.6	5.7	202606	40.3	-17.3	27.0	78.4	-0.6	5.6	0.4	446.8	219.4
Bajaj Auto	304.5	35.7	8.5	1.3	202606	34.4	-154.5	12.3	11.7	-2.9	24.9	0.6	391.9	266.9
Bajaj Corp	11684.0	428.9	27.2	8.3	202606	65.0	45.9	36.3	55.2	-3.0	28.4	0.4	12147.0	8490.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	11034.2	32.9	31.4	5.7	202606	19.6	27.4	18.8	17.6	-2.5	18.8	3.8	11177.6	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1917.3	64.9	29.5	3.9	202606	19.4	12.3	14.9	9.3	-2.7	11.8	5.2	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Housing	141.0	79.8	14.0	1.8	202606	21.0	32.0	28.0	36.7	6.5	16.1	0.8	1498.0	570.8
Bajaj Housing	3.2	2.5	3.9	3.1	202606	17.1	22.6	16.3	19.4	1.4	8.8	4.4	117.0	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	216.5	72.7	23.8	3.8	202606	25.2	56.4	9.8	-3.3	-5.1	10.9	0.0	2775.0	1971.5
Balaramchurni Chini [1]	69.2	17.5	39.5	3.2	202606	6.1	14.4	15.0	11.3	0.4	11.1	0.6	78.10	39.34
Birla Bank [1]	217.8	42.9	5.5	0.7	202606	6.8	68.2	4.9	-14.1	-0.6	0.0	0.0	325.6	23.4
Bank of Baroda [1]	13.9	25.9	5.4	0.8	202606	8.8	49.8	6.2	19.4	-3.6	0.0	0.0	178.5	116.0
Bank of India	84.2	9.8	9.8	1.9	202606	13.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	-1.8	0.0	0.0	94.5	53.5
Bank of Maharashtra [5]	474.5	10.5	47.5	10.5	202606	10.5	10.5	10.5	10.5	-2.6	12.1	1.8	474.5	10.5
Bayer Crop Science [5]	9880.0	162.9	24.4	6.0	202606	10.5	-2.8	23.6	10.5	-3.2	10.5	0.0	1487.9	385.0
Belfirst Industri [5]	22.80	5.3	4.32	3.2	202606	12.6	8.9	11.6	21.9	-3.8	14.1	1.1	26.80	13.92
BELM Ltd [5]	2024.1	21.4	94.5	5.8	202606	29.3	-142.1	12.8	12.8	5.1	5.1	0.7	2276.8	1361.0
Bergl Group [1]	458.4	10.5	43.5	10.5	202606	10.5	18.2	6.2	5.1	-1.6	21.3	0.1	594.3	39.9
Bharat Dynamics [5]	142.0	14.2	14.2	10.3	202606	144.7	-18.2	-18.2	-18.2	-18.2	0.0	0.0	133.3	109.0
Bharat Electron [1]	440.5	8.4	48.2	12.4	202606	24.9	8.7	19.8	11.7	0.1	34.8	0.0	473.3	38.0
Bharat Forge [2]	195.0	21.2	91.7	9.7	202606	18.7	-57.6	17.5	-1.3	-1.9	11.7	0.7	2293.0	1179.4
Bharti Airtel [5]	1832.0	10.4	52.9	6.5	202606	18.4	41.6	19.6	9.7	-0.5	19.3	1.6	2147.4	1745.0
Bharti Telecom [5]	1543.5	37.0	41.8	10.8	202606	19.0	23.2	7.9	27.6	3.2	10.5	0.0	195.0	143.0
Bhaski Foods [1]	54.85	10.4	25.6	8.6	202606	13.1	0.4	14.6	29.2	-6.1	20.1	0.2	80.4	87.1
Billmarrins Brn [2]	200.2	3.9	51.5	13.0	202606	66.0	94.3	37.7	30.8	3.1	37.2	0.1	227.0	12.0
Bilcon [5]	39.10	4.5	87.1	1.9	202606	9.8	287.0	10.1	103.2	-1.6	3.8	0.6	44.0	37.2
Birla Bank [1]	281.7	42.9	5.5	0.7	202606	6.8	68.2	4.9	-14.1	-0.6	0.0	0.0	325.6	23.4
BLS International [1]	231.7	17.1	13.5	3.9	202606	25.3	11.2	31.8	24.9	-2.9	39.0	0.1	737.6	218.5
Blue Dart Express	454.3	136.6	35.4	6.5	202606	15.0	8.2	9.2	30.8	-2.9	15.0	0.3	303.0	46.0
Blue Star [2]	29.10	5.7	60.6	9.4	202606	13.3	-21.0	51.9	-0.9	-5.2	19.6	0.2	2032.0	1432.0
Bombardier [5]	4638.0	80.12	60.4	9.6	202606	10.6	6.3	13.6	6.3	-1.6	1.6	0.0	4880.0	580.6
Brambles Solut. [2]	16.86	-2.0			202606	13.3	-141.4	17.7	-24.2	-6.4	0.0	0.0	40.6	16.6
Brigade Indus. [2]	63.89	20.8	30.											

B H E L [2]	430.6	7.0	61.6	5.7	202606	40.3	17.3	27.0	739.4	-0.6	5.6	0.3	446.8	219.4
B P C L [2]	304.5	35.7		8.5	202606	43.4	-154.5	12.3	-11.1	-2.5	24.9	0.0	319.9	286.6
Bajaj Auto [1]	11684.0	428.9	27.2	8.3	202606	65.0	45.9	36.3	55.2	-2.0	28.4	0.4	12470.0	8490.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	1034.2	32.9	31.4	5.7	202606	19.6	27.4	18.8	17.6	-2.5	10.9	3.8	1177.6	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1917.3	64.9	29.5	3.9	202606	19.4	12.3	14.9	9.3	-2.7	11.8	5.2	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings [2]	1786.2	78.0	19.8	9.3	202606	21.0	32.0	28.0	36.7	6.5	16.1	0.8	1498.0	570.8
Bajaj Housing	84.2	3.2	25.9	3.1	202606	17.1	22.6	16.3	19.4	1.4	8.8	4.4	117.0	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2165.5	72.7	29.8	3.8	202606	25.2	56.4	9.8	-3.3	-5.1	10.9	0.4	2775.0	1971.4
Balrampur Chini [1]	692.6	17.5	39.5	3.2	202606	6.1	14.4	15.0	-11.3	0.4	11.1	0.6	781.0	393.4
Banar Bank [2]	236.7	42.9	5.5	0.7	202606	6.8	68.2	4.9	14.1	-0.6	0.0	0.0	325.6	23.4
Bank of Baroda [2]	139.8	25.9	5.4	0.8	202606	8.8	49.8	6.2	19.4	-3.6	0.0	0.0	178.5	116.0
Bank of India [2]	84.2	9.8	8.6	1.9	202606	31.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	-1.8	0.0	0.0	94.5	31.0
Bank of Maharashtra [5]	79.0	47.9	2.5	0.7	202606	3.5	34.3	-0.2	34.1	-5.7	-6.2	2.8	1.0	1.0
Bayer Crop Sci.	3980.0	162.9	24.4	6.0	202606	-4.2	15.4	-2.8	23.6	-0.2	28.0	0.0	5987.9	3865.0
Besliste Industri [5]	228.0	5.5	43.2	3.2	202606	12.6	8.9	11.6	29.1	-3.8	14.1	0.1	268.0	139.1
BEMIL Ltd [1]	224.1	21.4	94.5	5.8	202606	29.3	-142.1	12.8	-40.3	-1.6	5.7	0.1	226.8	336.2
Bharat Paints [1]	1183.5	78.0	19.8	9.3	202606	21.0	32.0	28.0	36.7	6.5	16.1	0.8	1498.0	570.8
Bharat Dynamics [5]	1190.5	14.2	83.8	10.3	202606	144.8	547.4	-18.3	-7.1	-5.4	10.2	0.0	1655.3	1090.0
Bharat Electron [1]	405.5	8.4	48.2	12.4	202606	24.9	8.7	19.8	11.7	0.1	34.8	0.0	473.3	380.4
Bharat Forge [2]	1940.0	21.2	91.7	9.7	202606	18.7	57.6	17.5	-13.1	-1.9	17.7	0.0	1923.0	1179.4
Bharat Heavy Ele. [2]	1654.0	52.7	36.2	4.3	202606	38.0	13.4	21.7	19.7	-1.5	12.7	0.1	424.9	306.4
Bharat Hexacom [5]	1545.5	37.8	41.8	10.8	202606	10.9	23.2	7.9	28.6	3.2	20.5	1.0	2550.5	1431.0
Bikaji Foods [1]	548.5	10.4	52.6	8.6	202606	13.1	0.4	14.6	29.2	-6.1	20.1	0.2	801.0	547.1
Billionbrains [2]	200.2	3.9	15.5	13.0	202606	66.0	94.3	37.7	30.8	3.1	37.2	0.1	227.4	122.0
Birla Finance [2]	1832.5	15.5	87.3	1.9	202606	3.9	287.2	10.1	103.2	-1.6	0.6	0.6	630.2	337.2
Birlasoft [2]	281.1	21.3	13.2	1.5	202606	7.4	51.3	1.8	26.1	-2.7	10.0	0.0	473.8	270.2
BLS Internat. [1]	231.7	17.5	13.2	2.0	202606	25.3	11.2	31.8	24.9	-2.9	39.0	0.1	273.6	218.5

Brighter shades but priced in

PAINTS. Asian Paints’ valuation adequately balances margin levers and competitive pressures

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

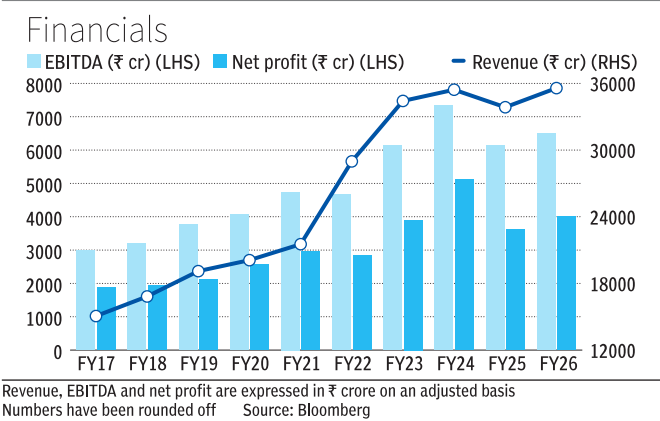
Asian Paints remains India’s leading decorative paints player, with formidable brand strength, distribution reach and manufacturing scale. Q1FY27 also showed an improvement in growth momentum. However, the competitive reset triggered by new capacity, particularly Birla Opus, is far from over, while the stock still trades at a demanding valuation of about 50 times trailing earnings. Existing investors can stay invested, but the risk-reward is not compelling enough for a fresh entry at this stage. We therefore recommend a hold.

The stock is around a level first seen in December 2020 and is down about 31 per cent from its peak, reflecting a sharp change in industry dynamics. Asian Paints, once seen as a relatively unchallenged compounder, now has to spend more on marketing and execute harder to defend market share while investing for the next phase of growth. Key monitorables include whether volume growth can hold after recent price hikes, how margins respond as higher-cost raw material inventory flows through, and whether backward integration can offset some of the pressure.

COMPETITIVE RESET

India’s decorative paints market is estimated at around ₹80,000 crore in FY27, with the unorganised segment accounting for about 22 per cent. Per-capita paint consumption in India, at around 3.5 kg a year, remains well below the global average of about 10 kg, leaving considerable headroom for growth. The organised market is expected to grow at over 10 per cent annually over the next decade.

Yet near-term industry economics have become tougher. In FY26, Asian Paints’ volume grew 9 per cent, while value growth was only 5.3 per cent, pointing to weak pricing. Birla Opus’ ₹10,000-crore investment has intensified competition; it is targeting ₹10,000 crore in revenue and the No. 2 position by FY28. New and expanding players can take share from incumbents, although a stronger organised network can also draw business from the unorganised segment. JSW has



HOLD

Asian Paints ₹2,470

WHY

- Volume growth recovering
- Solid financial position
- Distribution harder to defend now

further strengthened competition through its acquisition of Akzo Nobel India, now JSW Dulux, bringing the established Dulux brand and distribution network under a large corporate parent.

Asian Paints’ FY26 revenue was ₹35,583 crore, with decorative paints and home décor contributing 86.8 per cent, international operations 9.4 per cent and industrial coatings 3.8 per cent. Revenue has grown at only about 1 per cent CAGR over the past three years. FY26 consolidated EBITDA margin was about 18.3 per cent.

The company has responded to competition with higher marketing spends, product launches and trade support. Discounts, rebates, credit, incentives on gross sales rose from 15.4 per cent in FY22 to 20.5 per cent in FY26. This deserves watching, but the larger

point is simply that defending distribution is now costlier.

Q1 REBOUND

Against this backdrop, Q1FY27 was encouraging. Consolidated revenue rose 17.9 per cent year on year to about ₹10,542 crore. Domestic decorative paint volumes grew 9 per cent, while value growth was about 16-17 per cent. Rural markets grew faster than urban markets, while the B2B business, including industrial coatings, also supported growth. International business was another bright spot, with revenue rising about 27 per cent in rupee terms.

Importantly, management indicated that demand remained healthy during the quarter, with no meaningful inventory build-up. Decorative value growth of about 16.6 per cent was supported by 9 per

cent volume growth, with the balance coming from realisation growth. Favourable product mix contributed around 3 percentage points to the increase in realisations.

Margins were particularly strong. Gross margin improved about 90 basis points year on year to 43.6 per cent, while EBITDA margin expanded about 240 basis points to 20.6 per cent. However, the quarter benefited from low-cost raw material inventory. Raw material inflation was about 25 per cent, and higher-cost inventory is expected to weigh on Q2. Management has nevertheless retained its FY27 guidance of 8-10 per cent decorative volume growth and an 18-20 per cent EBITDA margin.

Products launched over the past three years now contribute about 16 per cent of sales, with greater emphasis on premium emulsions, waterproofing, wood finishes and other value-added categories.

COSTS AND VALUATION

Asian Paints is investing heavily to protect its cost position. Property, plant and equipment increased from ₹4,146 crore in FY23 to ₹7,146 crore in FY26. Projects include backward integration at Dahej for key vinyl raw materials, brownfield expansion at Ankleshwar, a bath-fittings facility at Wada and a white-cement project in Fujairah.

The company is also backward integrating into key raw materials through its vinyl acetate monomer (VAM) and vinyl acetate ethylene (VAE) facility. The VAM-VAE project should further strengthen the cost structure, with the first phase expected to be commissioned in Q2FY27. Management has indicated potential gross-margin benefits of 300-500 basis points for products using in-house emulsion, particularly in the premium and luxury categories. This should not, however, be interpreted as a 300-500-basis-point improvement in company-wide gross margin.

The balance sheet remains comfortable. FY26 debt stood at about ₹2,293 crore, while cash and current investments together were about ₹7,360 crore. At the same time, return on equity has declined to 21.2 per cent in FY26 from more than 25 per cent consistently in the 10 years before FY24. Recent investments will therefore need to translate into stronger growth and returns over the next few years.

Asian Paints trades at around 50 times earnings, below its five-year median of about 64 times and well below the peak multiple of 113 times seen in January 2022. However, a lower multiple does not automatically make the stock cheap when industry dynamics have changed. Berger Paints trades at roughly 47 times earnings, Indigo Paints at about 36 times and Kansai Nerolac at about 26 times.

Asian Paints is still holding its ground, and its scale, brand, distribution and backward-integration investments leave it better placed than smaller players if the industry eventually consolidates. However, the next leg of upside depends on proving that volume growth and market share can be protected without structurally sacrificing margins or returns on capital. For now, that balance supports a hold rather than a fresh buy.

Charged up chemicals but at a premium

SPECIALTY CHEMICALS. Acutaas Chemicals offers a multi vertical growth runway

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

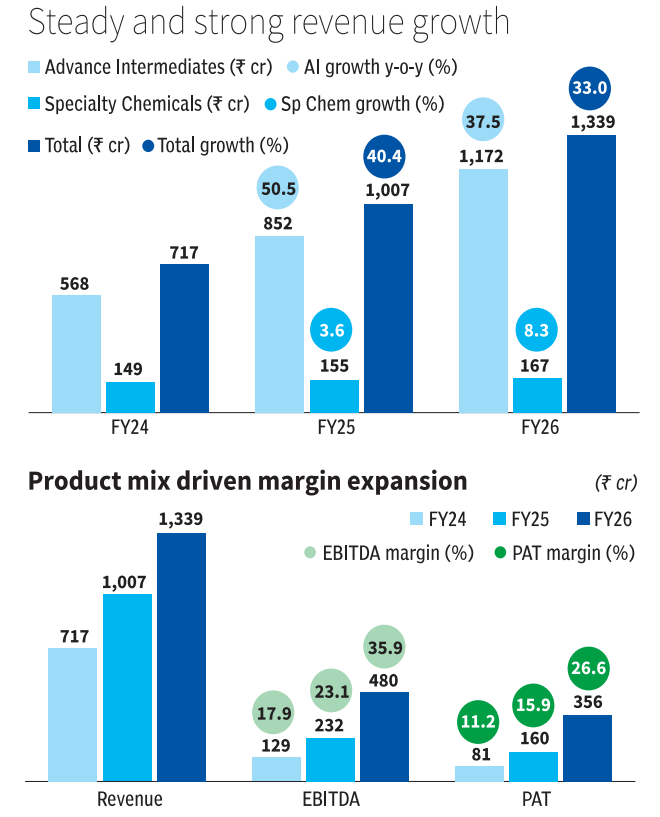
Acutaas Chemicals has delivered close to 6x returns since its IPO in 2021, supported by a 31 per cent revenue CAGR and 45 per cent EPS CAGR over FY21-26. The company has also expanded beyond its core advanced pharma intermediates business into CDMO contracts, battery chemicals (BC) and semiconductor chemicals (SC). The improved product mix has helped drive a 1,200-bps expansion in EBITDA margins over FY21-26 to 34 per cent in FY26.

Over the next few years, the company is expected to sustain a similar pace of revenue growth while maintaining its margin profile. However, with the stock trading at 55 times one-year forward earnings, against its five-year average of 40 times, the valuation premium is steep. We nevertheless recommend investors hold the stock. Of the three new verticals, CDMO is already in the growth phase, BC is in the launch phase and SC is in the build-out phase, together providing the company with a long growth runway.

ADVANCED INTERMEDIATES

Advanced Intermediates accounted for 87 per cent of FY26 revenue and reported a 44 per cent revenue CAGR during FY24-26, making it the key driver of overall growth.

Within the segment, CDMO operations have been the primary growth driver. The company has built a dedicated facility to supply intermediates for darolutamide, an anti-cancer prostate cancer drug developed by Bayer and Orion. This has



driven rapid growth in the division and contributed to margin improvement. Further growth from the molecule will depend on the CDMO agreement. However, given the robust growth in the end product, the outlook for Acutaas’ intermediate sales remains strong.

The CDMO division has validated four more products and is expected to see a growth ramp-up in FY27. Each of the four products has a peak revenue potential of ₹50-100 crore, which could be reached during FY27-28. This compares with consolidated FY26 revenue of ₹1,340 crore. Similar to the anti-cancer drug, these products are expected

to benefit from stable and visible sales growth in growing end-markets. The division is also developing a pipeline of additional products, some of which are already in the validation phase, supporting continued growth beyond the first set of products.

SPECIALITY CHEMICALS

The battery chemicals division is supported by strong demand from long-term customer contracts and a pipeline of products under development.

The first two products, Vinylene Carbonate (VC) and Fluoroethylene Carbonate (FEC), each with a capacity of

HOLD

Acutaas Chemicals ₹3,377.35

WHY

- CDMO operations to expand
- New divisions of battery followed by semiconductor chemicals to launch this year
- Valuations capture growth prospects

2,000 tonnes per annum, started production in Q1FY27 and are expected to ramp up gradually over the next two years. Production is backed by long-term contracts with companies in North America and South Korea. The two products are expected to generate around ₹300 crore a year at peak capacity utilisation.

The company also has a pipeline of products under development. A facility for the third product is being developed and is expected to start generating revenue in FY27, while a fourth product is in the validation phase.

Acutaas manufactures semiconductor-grade speciality chemicals through Baba Fine Chemicals and its 75 per cent-owned JV, Indichem, with a Korean company. The company acquired a 55 per cent stake in Baba Fine Chemicals in April 2023 for around ₹70 crore. The target company manufactures speciality chemicals for the semiconductor industry. Following the acquisition, Acutaas has expanded both its product portfolio and geographic reach, driving revenue growth.

The facility being developed

under the JV with the Korean company, at a total cost of ₹200 crore, is expected to be completed by the end of this calendar year, with revenues starting to accrue from FY28. Assuming a conservative asset turnover ratio of 1x, the facility could generate around ₹200 crore at peak utilisation, potentially within three years.

FINANCIALS

The company has guided for 25 per cent YoY growth in FY27 while maintaining EBITDA margins. The four upcoming CDMO products, two battery chemicals, and the Indichem semiconductor chemicals facility are expected to add around 60 per cent of incremental revenue over the FY26 base in the next three years. Growth from the existing portfolio of advanced pharma intermediates and speciality chemicals is also expected to support overall growth, as the company completes a portfolio reshuffle towards higher-margin products this year.

Over the longer term, the company has reported strong flows of enquiries for its CDMO business and is developing a pipeline of products in both battery and semiconductor chemicals. To support this development, it plans to significantly expand its R&D facility into a multi-disciplinary centre covering pharma, agro, semiconductor, battery and cosmetics chemicals. Details on land acquisition and development costs are expected to be announced this year.

With net debt-to-EBITDA at -0.40 as of March 2026, indicating cash in excess of debt, the company should have the financial capacity to fund its R&D and expansion plans.

businessline’s editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

REALITY CHECK.

ESDS Software Solution: After 4x surge, book profit now

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

In our *bl.portfolio* edition dated August 30, 2026 we had recommended investors with high-risk appetite subscribe to the IPO of IT infrastructure services provider ESDS Software Solution (<https://tinyurl.com/esdsipo>). The long-term view was based on fundamentals, but since listing, many years of gains have been realised in just six trading sessions. Hence, investors can book profit in ESDS shares after the extraordinary post-listing rally.

At ₹1,716.35 (BSE) on Friday close, the stock is trading at about four times its ₹429 issue price. ESDS listed on September 4 (Friday) at ₹746.30 on the BSE, a nearly 74 per cent premium to the issue price. The stock closed the debut session at ₹895.55 — up 109 per cent over IPO price. The rally has continued since, with the stock hitting the 20 per cent upper circuit each on both Monday and Tuesday, and thereafter the 10 per cent upper circuit on Wednesday, Thursday and this Friday. Its market value has consequently surged from around ₹5,000 crore at the IPO price to over ₹20,000 crore. Limited free float may have amplified the rally, with current freely traded shares representing only about 11-12 per cent of ESDS’ market capitalisation, as per BSE website data.

Not much has changed in fundamentals, in our view, to justify a four-fold rise. In fact, following a BSE query on the sharp price movement, ESDS said on September 9 that it had disclosed all material information and that there was no undisclosed price-sensitive information or impending corporate action that could affect the stock. The company also said it was unaware of any specific reason for the significant price movement and attributed it to market-driven trading activity.

PRICE RUNS AHEAD

ESDS Software Solution provides the computing infrastructure that companies, banks and government bodies need to run their IT systems. Customers can rent computing power and storage from ESDS instead of buying their own servers. They can also house their own servers at ESDS data centres and pay for space, power and connectivity. ESDS can manage customers’ IT systems and also sells software through the internet. It also operates Swaraj Cloud, its patented India-based platform for businesses and government organisations seeking locally hosted computing and storage, with data hosted within India.

At the IPO price, ESDS was valued at about 41.6 times FY26 earnings. We considered that reasonable, though not cheap, given its 28 per cent revenue CAGR and 52 per cent EBITDA CAGR over FY24-26, and the sharp improvement in profitability, with PAT rising ninefold since FY24. At ₹1,716 levels, the same FY26 earnings are now valued at roughly 166 times. The business remains attractive, but the price investors are being asked to pay for it has changed dramatically.

The two large AI-computing projects discussed in our IPO analysis remain potentially significant. Our original investment case, however, deliberately did not assign value to them because their eventual revenue and profit economics were insufficiently clear. At the IPO price, they provided optionality. At the current price, the market appears to be pricing in a substantial portion of future success even before that becomes visible in reported earnings.

There is another interesting contrast. E2E Networks, the listed peer mentioned in ESDS’ RHP, whose steep valuation provided relative comfort for ESDS at the IPO price, has not participated in this frenzy. E2E closed at ₹602 on September 4 and is around ₹611 currently, broadly flat over the period. Note, E2E is still extremely highly valued itself (404x P/E). ESDS has, meanwhile, more than doubled even from its day-1 closing price. This does not mean ESDS’s business prospects have deteriorated. Its core business continues to offer growth potential, while successful execution of the AI projects could materially increase its scale. But at around ₹20,000 crore market capitalisation and 166 times FY26 earnings, expectations have run far ahead of fundamentals.

Readers can watch out for *bl.portfolio*’s analysis of NSE’s IPO in our edition on September 20, 2026

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I am entering the golden jubilee year of my business, though I got listed only 30 years ago.
- I have been among the top three players globally, with about one-fifth share of global trade.
- My cumulative profit over the trailing seven years is less than the profit I earned in the year preceding this period.
- I have delivered twice the index returns to my shareholders over the last three years despite negative growth in earnings.
- My founder group has several listed companies in another industry, and their combined market capitalisation is less than mine.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Investing With Conviction

Last week’s stock:
Rashi Peripherals
Last week’s winner:
Rithvika Murali

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index fell sharply last week breaking below their key support. Nifty and Sensex were down over 2 per cent each. Nifty Bank index on the other hand fell 1.33 per cent for the week.

On the charts, the picture is looking weak. Resistances are there to cap the upside. So, any rise from current levels can be capped. We expect the Nifty, Sensex and the Nifty Bank index to fall either from here itself or after a short-lived corrective rise.

FPIS SELL

The Foreign Portfolio Investors sold Indian equities for the second consecutive week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$602 million last week. With this, the FPIs have pulled out about \$1.38 billion so far this month.

NIFTY 50 (23,398.10)

Short-term view: Immediate support is in the 23,250-23,200 region. A rise from here and a break above 23,450 can trigger a relief rise to 23,700. However, a break above 23,700 is less likely. We can expect the Nifty to turn down again from around 23,700 and fall back to 23,200.

Eventually, we can expect the Nifty to break 23,200 and fall to 22,600-22,500. This fall can happen either from here itself or after a corrective rise to 23,700.

Medium-term view: Nifty is now coming down towards the lower end of its 22,000-26,500 range. We expect this broad sideways range to remain intact. So, Nifty is likely to rise back from the 22,500-22,000 support zone. That leg of rise can take it back up to 24,000 and higher.

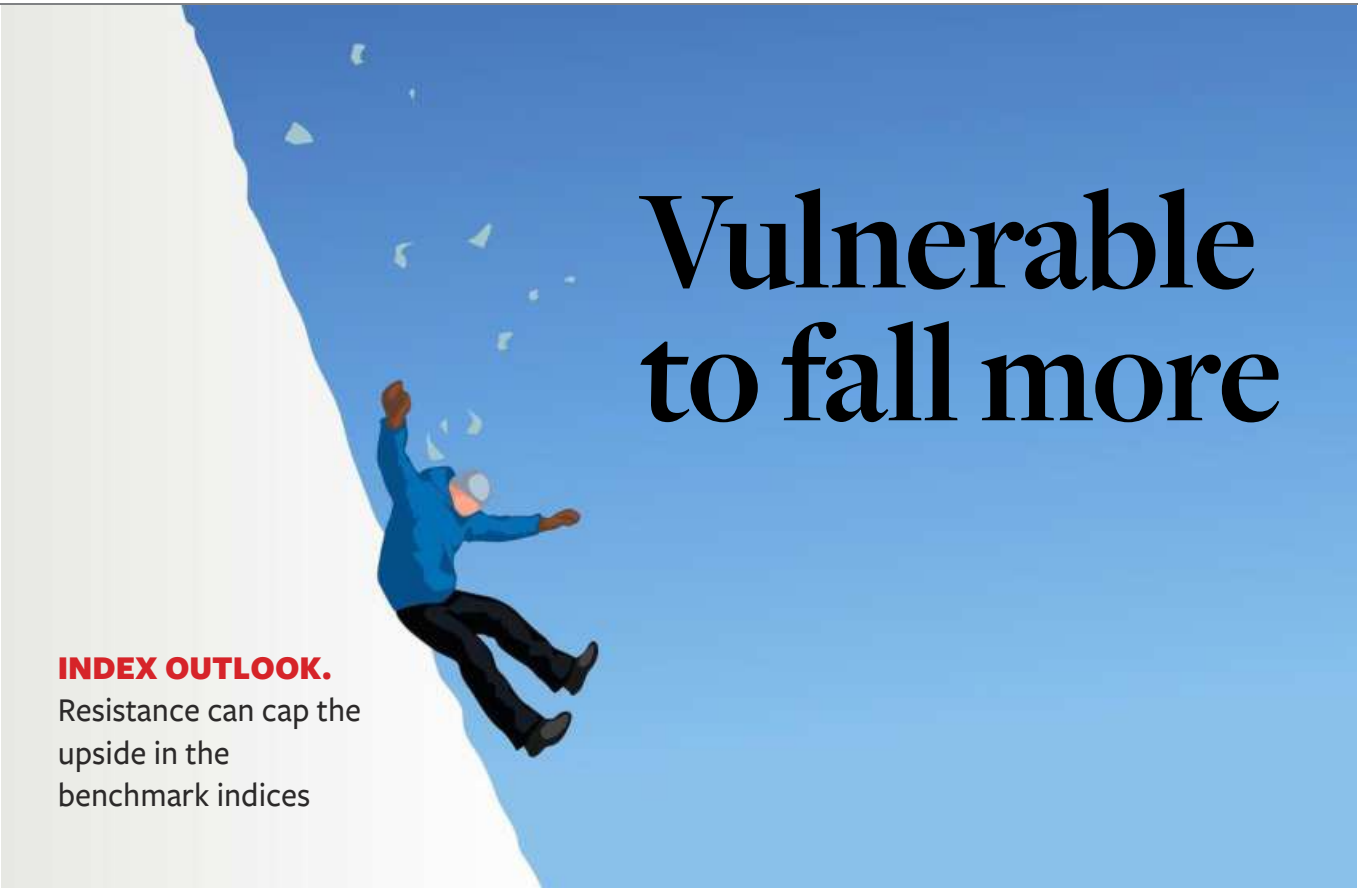
We continue to retain our long-term bullish stance. So, Nifty is likely to make a bullish breakout above 26,500 and rise to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

A break below 22,000 is needed to prove our bullish view wrong. That would need some new and strong negative trigger.

NIFTY BANK (56,606.55)

Short-term view: Resistance is near current levels at 56,700. A break above it can give some relief and take the Nifty Bank index higher to 57,200-57,300.

But failure to breach 56,700



INDEX OUTLOOK.

Resistance can cap the upside in the benchmark indices

Nifty 50: Sell-off intensifies



can keep the index under pressure. In that case, there is a danger of seeing more fall towards 55,000 and even 54,000. We will have to wait and watch.

Medium-term view: The level of 54,000 is a crucial support. A strong bounce from there can take the Nifty Bank index higher to 57,000 and 60,000 again. It will also keep the overall bullish view intact to see a break above 60,000 and rise to 65,000 in the medium term. That in turn will also keep the upside open to see 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

In case, the index breaks below 54,000, an extended fall to 51,000-50,000 is possible. Nifty Bank index has to decline below 50,000 to negate our long-term

bullish view.

SENSEX (74,781.76)

Short-term view: The strong fall below 76,000 has turned the short-term picture negative. Immediate resistance is at 74,900. Above that 75,400 is the next important resistance.

There is room on the downside to see 73,500-73,400. A break below 74,180, an intermediate support, can trigger this fall. A bounce thereafter can take the Sensex higher to 75,000.

Medium-term view: Sensex is now coming down within the broad 71,000-86,000 range. Intermediate support is at 73,400. A break below it can drag the index down towards 71,000.

IMMEDIATE RESISTANCE

- Nifty 50: 23,450
- Sensex: 74,900
- Nifty Bank: 56,700

We expect the index to bounce back from around 71,000 and retain the sideways range.

We also retain our long-term bullish view of seeing a break above 86,000 and a rise to 90,000 and 94,000 in the long term.

The bullish view will go wrong only if the Sensex breaks below 71,000.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,847.85)

The bounce from the low of 22,569.05 on Wednesday has given some relief. However, the short-term picture looks weak. Resistance can be in the 22,900-23,000 region. A sustained rise above 23,000 can give some relief and take the index higher to 23,200 this week.

But failure to breach 23,000 can keep the downside open to see 22,200-22,000.

There is no change in our broader bullish view. A fall beyond 22,000 is less likely. We continue to retain our bullish view of seeing 26,000-26,500 in the medium-term and 28,000 in the

long term. A break above 24,000 can clear the way for this rally.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (18,339.90)

The index seems to be struggling to get a strong follow-through rise above 18,500. But at the same time, it is also getting support around 18,150.

For now, the broader bullish view is intact. A decisive break above 18,500 can take the index up to 19,000-19,200 initially. The upside remains open to see 22,500-23,000 in the medium term and 24,000-24,500 in the long term.

In case, the index breaks 18,150 and falls below 18,000, then 17,600-17,400 can be seen on the downside. Such a fall will only delay the expected rally to 23,000 and 24,000 and will not negate that.



Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English



Tamil

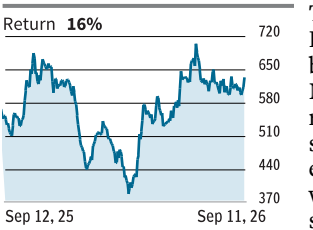


MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Allied Blenders and Distillers (₹631.85)

Broader uptrend intact

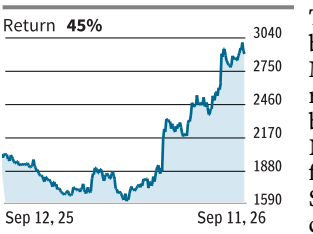


The stock of Allied Blenders and Distillers has been oscillating between ₹585 and ₹650. Nevertheless, the broader trend remains bullish so long as the support at ₹585 holds. We expect the stock to build on last week's 3.7 per cent rally and surpass ₹650. Once this happens, the stock can

appreciate to ₹780 soon. Hence, traders can buy the stock now at ₹631 and accumulate if the price dips to ₹610. Place initial stop-loss at ₹560. When the price goes up to ₹700, move the stop-loss higher to ₹660. Raise the stop-loss to ₹720 when the stock rises to ₹750. Exit at ₹780.

Gland Pharma (₹2,922.70)

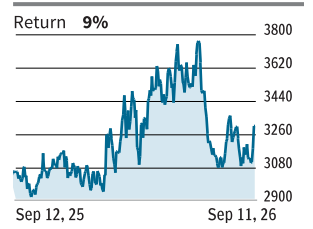
In a steady bull trend



moving average and an important support at ₹2,770. The stock can resume the rally soon and appreciate to ₹3,500 over the medium-term. So, traders can buy now at ₹2,922 and accumulate if the price drops to ₹2,850. Keep initial stop-loss at ₹2,700. When the stock rises to ₹3,200 and ₹3,400, alter the stop-loss to ₹3,000 and ₹3,300 respectively. Exit at ₹3,500.

Timken India (₹3,300.35)

Breakout anticipated



soon. This will open the door for a fresh leg of rally to ₹4,100. So, participants can go long now at ₹3,300 and buy more shares if the price falls to ₹3,150. Place stop-loss at ₹3,000. When the price hits ₹3,650, raise the stop-loss to ₹3,400. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹3,750 when the stock touches ₹3,900. Book profits at ₹4,100.

Equities fall, yields rise

US MARKET OUTLOOK. Treasury yield coming close to a key resistance

Gurumurthy K

bl. research outlook

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index fell last week. The Dow Jones was down 1.57 per cent for the week. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index fell 0.8 per cent and 0.66 per cent, respectively.

The US Treasury Yields surged last week following the strong rise in the Crude Oil price. This dragged the equity markets lower. The 2 per cent fall in the oil price on Friday aided the US benchmark indices to recover some of their loss.

Can the equity markets sustain the bounce seen on Friday and go further higher? Here is an analysis.

DOW JONES (52,578.27)

The strong fall below 52,900 last week has turned the bias negative. Cluster of resistances are there in the broad 52,900-53,200 region. So, any further rise from current levels can be capped.

Support is at 52,200. The index can remain vulnerable to break this support and fall to 51,800 initially. A further break below 51,800 can then drag the Dow Jones down to 50,000-49,500 over the medium term.

To avoid this fall, the Dow Jones has to get a sustained rise above 53,500.

S&P 500 (7,656.98)

The support at 7,600 continues to hold well. The index made a low of 7,580 and has bounced back from there. If this bounce sustains, then there are good chances to see a rise to 7,720 this week.

A decisive break above 7,720 will clear the way for the rise to 7,800. We reiterate that a strong break above 7,800 will be bullish to see 8,000 on the upside.

On the other hand, if the S&P 500 index fails to rise above 7,720 from here, it can fall back to 7,600 again. A break below 7,600 will



RANGE BOUND

The US dollar index is stuck inside the 98.50-99.85 range for three continuous weeks.

see a test of 7,550 or even 7,500.

From a big picture, the index has to decline below 7,500 in order to negate the rise to 8,000 completely.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,333.04)

The index is stuck between 25,900 and 26,700 over the last three weeks. That keeps alive the chances of seeing 27,000-27,200 on the upside.

If it manages to breach 27,200, then an extended rise to 28,000-28,200 is also a possibility that cannot be ruled out.

We reiterate that a rise beyond 28,200 is less likely. We expect the NASDAQ Composite index to find a top around 28,000-28,200.

A reversal thereafter can take it down towards 27,000-26,000 and even lower.

The index will come under pressure if it breaks below 25,900. If that happens, a fall to 25,500-25,000 can be seen. We need to wait and watch.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (99.09) continues to remain inside the 98.50-99.85 range. So, there is no major change in the view. The short-term picture will continue to remain mixed until the range break-out happens on either side.

A sustained rise above 99.85 is needed for the index to gain momentum and surpass the psychological 100 mark again. Only then a rise to 101 and higher levels will come back into the picture.

On the other hand, a break below 98.50 can drag the index down to 98.20-98. From a big picture, the dollar index has to sustain above 98 to avoid further fall.

TREASURY YIELD

The expected rise to 5 per cent on the US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.97 per cent) has happened much faster than expected. An extended rise to 5.05-5.08 per cent is a possibility if the current momentum sustains. But, thereafter the yield can turn down again towards 5-4.95 per cent. A break below 4.95 per cent can then drag the yield down to 4.8 per cent.

In case the yield manages to breach 5.08 per cent, then 5.25-5.3 per cent can be seen on the upside. The price action this week is going to be very important.

TECH QUERY

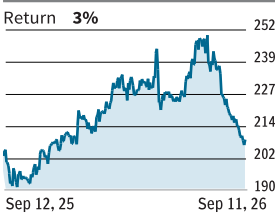


GURUMURTHY K, bl.research bureau

I am holding shares of Lupin. My purchase price is ₹2,267.50. What is the long-term outlook?

Nipun Prabhu

Lupin (₹2,096): The stock has come down sharply after making a high of ₹2,530 in mid-July. The fall this month has dragged the price well below the key support level of ₹2,120. The outlook is negative. There is a danger of the price falling to ₹1,800 from here. Any intermediate bounce can face resistance in the ₹2,100-₹2,200 region. Also, if the price declines below ₹1,800, then there

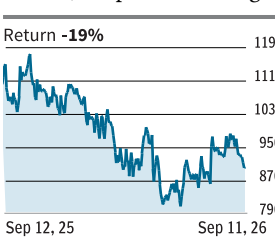


is a danger of the price tumbling towards ₹1,600 or even ₹1,400 over the long term. It is better to exit the stock now and accept the loss rather than hoping for the price to rise back. If you intend to wait, then that may result in a much higher loss. Because the picture is clearly weak on the charts.

I am looking for a suitable entry price in KFin Technologies. What is the technical outlook for this stock?

Nishant

KFin Technologies (₹899): The stock is stuck inside a range of ₹785-₹1,005 since March this year. Within that, the price is coming down now and can see

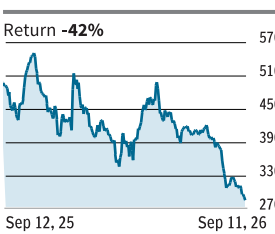


₹830-₹820 in the coming weeks. From a big picture, cluster of resistances are there in the ₹980-₹1,100 region. A sustained rise above ₹1,100 is needed to turn the outlook bullish. Only then a fresh rally to ₹1,400 and higher levels will come into play. On the other hand, a break below ₹780 will be bearish. It will then drag the price down to ₹675. Such a fall will make it very difficult for the share price to go back above ₹1,000 again. Overall, it is a wait-and-watch situation for now. Stay out of this stock.

What is the long-term outlook for KPI Green Energy? I have bought this stock at ₹388. Can I accumulate now or exit?

Neeraj Kumar. Mumbai

KPI Green Energy (₹281.55): The trend is down and strong. However, a crucial long-term support is coming up in the ₹275-₹265 region. A bounce from this



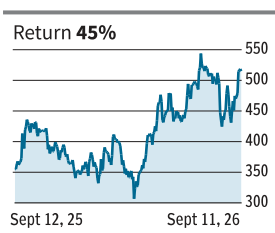
support zone and a subsequent rise above ₹340 can trigger a rise to ₹450. But, if the price declines below ₹265, then ₹200 and lower levels can be seen. If you have a high-risk appetite, then accumulate at ₹275. Keep a stop-loss at ₹255. Move

the stop-loss up to ₹310 when the price goes up to ₹340. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹360 and ₹410 when the price touches ₹390 and ₹430, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹445. If you do not want to take risk, then exit the stock now and accept the loss.

I have shares of Goodluck India bought at ₹277. What is the outlook?

Pavan Varma

Goodluck India (₹517): The trend is up since February last year. The stock is now getting very good support in the ₹450-₹400 region. The share price can



rise to ₹600-₹650 in the short-term. From a big picture, there is potential for share price to target ₹715 in the coming months. You can hold the stock. However, it is important to protect your profit. So, keep a stop-loss at ₹405 now. Move the

stop-loss up to ₹460 and ₹510 when the price touches ₹550 and ₹590, respectively. Exit 50 per cent of your holding at ₹620 and move the stop-loss up to ₹580 for the balance holdings. When the price goes up to ₹670 thereafter, shift your stop-loss up to ₹620, Exit the balance holdings at ₹700.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week		Last week's prize winner Palak Sangoi
BANDU'S PICKS	1 Jubilant Pharmova	Last week's winning stock Wockhardt
	2 Physicswallah	Closing price (Sep 04) ₹2,086.75
	3 Granules India	Closing price (Sep 11) ₹2,181.50
	4 Emmvee Photovoltaic Power	Return: 4.52 per cent
	5 Five-Star Business Finance	

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	105.3	80206	1.1	0.7	-4.9	9.6	10.6	12.4	0.37
*****	Invesco India Largecap	71.6	2021	1.8	0.7	2.2	12.0	10.2	11.9	0.31
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	87.4	54134	1.2	0.6	-4.6	9.2	12.2	12.9	0.42
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	218.2	2641	1.7	0.7	-0.3	9.8	9.4	11.6	0.30
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	60.4	17092	1.4	0.5	-4.3	8.5	7.6	12.1	0.24
*****	JM Large Cap	152.2	394	2.1	0.8	-0.9	8.8	9.6	10.3	0.29
*****	SBI Large Cap	90.8	55140	1.2	0.7	-2.1	7.6	8.5	10.8	0.28
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	507.2	29711	1.4	0.8	-3.8	8.1	8.4	10.6	0.27
***	Bandhan Large Cap	77.3	2180	1.7	0.8	0.2	11.1	9.3	11.6	0.28
***	DSP Large Cap	442.7	7101	1.5	0.8	-6.3	9.0	8.0	9.5	0.25
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	82.3	1434	1.8	0.6	-1.6	8.2	8.4	11.4	0.26
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	996.8	7490	1.5	0.9	-3.3	8.3	7.4	9.7	0.23
***	HDFC Large Cap	1110.1	39933	1.3	0.8	-2.4	8.1	10.6	11.5	0.35
***	HSBC Large Cap	471.4	1855	1.8	1.0	-0.6	8.7	8.2	10.9	0.23
***	Kotak Large Cap	554.7	10937	1.5	0.6	-3.1	8.5	8.0	11.2	0.25
***	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.6	695	2.0	0.7	-6.3	6.4	6.8	-	0.20
***	Tata Large Cap	498.4	2765	1.7	0.8	-0.8	8.7	8.6	10.7	0.27
**	Groww Largecap	42.2	137	2.1	0.9	-1.8	8.8	8.0	9.8	0.22
**	Mirae Asset Large Cap	109.5	38166	1.3	0.5	-3.6	6.9	6.8	11.3	0.21
**	Union Largecap	22.8	437	2.1	1.3	-3.5	6.4	6.7	-	0.19
**	UTI Large Cap	259.9	12189	1.5	0.8	-5.5	6.0	5.9	10.3	0.17
*	Axis Large Cap	59.1	31376	1.3	0.6	-2.9	7.8	4.8	10.9	0.11
*	LIC MF Large Cap	52.7	1385	1.8	0.9	-5.8	6.3	5.2	9.1	0.14
*	PGIM India Large Cap	325.3	538	2.1	0.8	-5.2	5.5	5.2	8.9	0.14
-	Taurus Large Cap	167.3	60	2.1	1.9	6.4	12.1	10.2	9.7	0.29
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	140.0	21020	1.4	0.4	3.5	16.0	15.5	14.4	0.49
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1024.7	33592	1.3	0.7	1.4	13.9	15.4	14.3	0.57
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	123.5	3487	1.7	0.6	10.2	12.8	14.5	14.8	0.42
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	34.9	17320	1.4	0.5	5.9	13.7	11.3	-	0.32
*****	HDFC Large & Mid Cap	343.3	30294	1.4	0.8	0.8	11.3	13.9	13.8	0.45
*****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	110.0	12387	1.5	0.5	7.8	21.0	16.1	15.7	0.45
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	182.2	6514	1.6	0.8	1.7	13.2	13.2	13.1	0.44
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	92.5	529	2.1	0.9	6.7	11.8	10.9	12.1	0.32
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	60.4	18411	1.4	0.5	-1.6	11.4	10.7	12.9	0.34
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	89.9	4942	1.6	0.5	3.9	12.2	11.7	13.7	0.37
***	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	30.1	5931	1.6	0.7	10.4	16.1	13.6	-	0.35
***	Kotak Large & Mid Cap	346.6	32325	1.3	0.5	1.6	11.5	12.1	13.8	0.38
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	155.2	45811	1.3	0.5	2.9	10.4	9.8	15.2	0.30
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1475.4	7903	1.5	0.9	-0.1	13.0	12.5	12.1	0.41
***	SBI Large & Midcap	632.0	42336	1.3	0.6	0.9	10.7	12.5	13.4	0.43
**	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	255.0	26331	1.4	0.5	-2.4	10.9	9.5	13.7	0.30
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	188.8	3622	1.6	1.1	-2.3	10.1	9.5	10.7	0.30
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	38.9	3198	1.7	0.5	1.2	11.8	10.3	13.1	0.32
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	93.5	7544	1.5	0.7	9.5	13.2	11.4	14.0	0.34
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	947.9	5998	1.6	0.9	5.2	9.8	7.0	10.3	0.19
*	Navi Large & Midcap	36.2	315	2.1	0.5	3.2	7.4	9.0	11.5	0.27
*	Tata Large & Mid Cap	489.1	7679	1.5	0.6	-5.7	5.3	8.2	11.2	0.25
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2035.2	113606	1.1	0.6	1.2	14.4	16.7	14.8	0.60
*****	JM Flexi Cap	99.9	5291	1.6	0.5	1.4	12.7	14.4	15.0	0.44
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	81.6	147405	1.1	0.5	-4.6	11.2	10.8	16.0	0.41
*****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1933.2	29044	1.4	0.7	7.5	13.4	10.9	12.8	0.34
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	38.5	3722	1.6	0.5	0.9	12.3	11.2	13.4	0.34
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1574.2	19385	1.4	0.8	-3.3	9.6	11.3	12.2	0.35
*****	HSBC Flexi Cap	234.2	6000	1.6	0.9	6.5	14.6	12.5	12.4	0.35
*****	Axis Flexi Cap	28.5	13943	1.5	0.6	5.2	12.9	8.2	-	0.22
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	206.2	7508	1.5	1.0	-1.6	9.3	9.0	10.2	0.28
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	338.1	13679	1.5	0.5	-1.9	9.9	8.3	12.9	0.26
***	DSP Flexi Cap	101.2	12500	1.5	0.6	-1.6	9.0	8.4	12.5	0.24
***	Kotak Flexi Cap	83.9	56392	1.2	0.5	-0.7	10.0	9.6	12.0	0.30
***	Navi Flexi Cap	24.8	297	2.1	0.5	9.3	8.9	9.5	-	0.29
***	PGIM India Flexi Cap	36.7	5963	1.6	0.5	0.0	8.4	6.8	12.6	0.19
***	Union Flexi Cap	52.5	2452	1.7	0.8	2.4	9.8	9.4	12.3	0.28
***	LIC MF Flexi Cap	106.9	1125	1.9	0.9	6.6	10.6	9.8	10.0	0.28
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	64.3	14160	1.4	0.7	2.1	16.7	12.2	12.3	0.33
**	SBI Flexicap	107.8	23235	1.4	0.7	-1.1	7.1	7.4	10.9	0.22
**	Tata Flexi Cap	23.1	3663	1.6	0.6	-5.7	7.9	7.5	-	0.23
**	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.3	131	2.1	0.8	-3.0	4.8	5.9	-	0.14
**	Taurus Flexi Cap	240.1	382	2.1	2.0	6.6	10.5	10.1	9.5	0.30
*	UTI Flexi Cap	321.6	24163	1.4	0.8	-2.9	7.0	4.2	11.1	0.10
-	Quant Flexi Cap	107.5	7364	1.5	0.6	12.4	13.5	13.7	17.9	0.38
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	294.0	3493	1.7	0.8	2.4	13.0	12.1	13.2	0.36
-	ICICI Pru Multi Cap	851.1	19538	1.4	0.8	7.4	14.3	14.2	13.6	0.48
-	Invesco India Multicap	132.8	4529	1.6	0.6	2.0	12.1	11.0	13.0	0.30
-	ITI Multi Cap	26.3	1543	1.8	0.5	11.7	14.9	12.5	-	0.36
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	39.8	7662	1.5	0.4	13.1	15.2	14.9	-	0.42
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	297.7	56298	1.2	0.6	-1.7	11.4	16.0	14.4	0.53
-	Quant Multi Cap	661.2	7725	1.5	0.6	7.2	8.1	10.7	16.7	0.28
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	393.8	3070	1.7	0.8	2.2	11.5	11.5	13.5	0.35
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	108.5	19891	1.4	0.4	7.2	18.7	17.2	17.4	0.50
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4472.6	52271	1.2	0.6	7.3	16.4	17.3	17.3	0.53
*****	Quant Mid Cap	218.4	8056	1.5	0.7	4.6	9.5	14.4	16.7	0.41
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	208.0	108325	1.1	0.6	6.4	15.7	18.3	16.3	0.61
*****	Invesco India Midcap	198.1	15905	1.4	0.5	9.1	21.4	18.5	17.9	0.51
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	36.1	5406	1.6	0.5	9.6	15.5	16.4	-	0.49
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	104.7	42852	1.3	0.6	-0.2	17.1	20.8	16.3	0.56
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	111.3	2658	1.7	0.5	9.8	14.8	14.0	14.6	0.42
***	HSBC Midcap	476.2	17188	1.4	0.5	20.2	22.5	18.1	16.6	0.47
***	ICICI Pru Mid Cap	340.2	8403	1.5	0.9	14.2	19.5	16.7	15.8	0.52
***	Kotak Mid Cap	145.0	71256	1.2	0.3	5.9	15.6	15.5	16.5	0.47
***	PGIM India Midcap	65.7	11218	1.5	0.5	-0.6	9.2	9.4	14.4	0.29
***	SBI Midcap	238.8	24518	1.4	0.7	4.1	8.9	12.7	13.0	0.41
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1484.2	14863	1.4	0.8	6.4	16.4	16.0	13.7	0.49
***	Tata Mid Cap	460.2	6240	1.6	0.5	6.2	12.9	13.8	15.3	0.43
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	841.9	6966	1.6	0.9	6.9	13.4	13.2	12.6	0.40
**	Axis Midcap	122.0	35425	1.3	0.5	6.9	14.7	12.2	16.3	0.37
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2796.9	13052	1.5	0.8	1.7	13.8	12.9	13.4	0.39
**	UTI Mid Cap	314.5	12795	1.5	0.7	3.8	10.3	11.2	13.1	0.33
*	DSP Midcap	153.4	21019	1.4	0.6	3.6	12.2	10.7	13.2	0.32
*	LIC MF Midcap	31.1	392	2.1	1.2	7.2	14.7	12.3	-	0.34
*	Taurus Mid Cap	128.1	140	2.1	1.7	4.1	8.3	12.1	13.8	0.34
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	58.5	3307	1.7	0.4	25.9	19.7	18.7	-	0.46
*****	Quant Small Cap	293.6	35557	1.3	0.6	15.4	15.9	18.6	20.0	0.45
*****	Edelweiss Small Cap	47.7	7253	1.5	0.4	8.4	13.3	15.6	-	0.46
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	48.4	15744	1.4	0.4	15.8	20.7	18.8	-	0.48

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV	Latest Corpus	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
		(₹)	(₹ Cr)	Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	185.4	82580	1.1	0.5	9.3	13.6	18.3	20.0	0.49
*****	Union Small Cap	61.0	2667	1.7	0.8	23.2	15.9	16.6	16.4	0.42
*****	AXIS Small Cap	117.7	31448	1.4	0.6	10.3	14.0	15.1	18.1	0.46
***	Canara Robeco Small Cap	41.0	14661	1.5	0.5	5.9	10.8	13.7	-	0.40
***	DSP Small Cap	231.9	21659	1.4	0.7	17.5	16.0	17.8	16.3	0.47
***	HSBC Small Cap	92.1	19076	1.4	0.6	13.3	13.0	16.9	17.7	0.42
***	Kotak Small Cap	274.2	19679	1.4	0.5	4.7	10.2	11.8	15.8	0.33
***	LIC MF Small Cap	35.9	832	2.0	0.8	17.0	17.1	17.5	-	0.44
***	Sundaram Small Cap	300.5	4155	1.6	0.7	15.2	15.6	16.2	14.3	0.43
**	Franklin Ind Small Cap	180.1	14746	1.5	0.8	5.8	11.6	15.4	14.2	0.41
**	Small Cap	139.0	41891	1.3	0.6	-2.9	9.2	14.3	16.2	0.39
**	ICICI Pru Small Cap	91.5	9821	1.5	0.7	3.1	9.5	13.6	14.9	0.42
**	Tata Small Cap	39.7	13094	1.5	0.4	-1.1	10.2	14.1	-	0.35
*	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	101.6	6226	1.6	0.8	19.2	14.3	15.3	12.6	0.34
*	SBI Small Cap	186.7	42631	1.3	0.6	7.5	10.7	13.7	17.7	0.41
EQUITY - FOCUSED FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Focused	229.7	28201	1.4	0.6	-1.5	13.6	16.9	13.3	0.61
*****	ICICI Pru Focused	93.2	17949	1.4	0.6	-0.1	14.8	14.2	13.7	0.46
*****	360 ONE Focused	48.9	6800	1.5	0.7	4.3	10.1	10.5	14.1	0.30
*****	Quant Focused	12.2	850	2.0	0.7	9.5	10.9	11.7	13.5	0.33
*****	SBI Focused	399.4	51248	1.2	0.6	11.9	14.5	11.2	14.2	0.38
***	Aditya Birla SL Focused	143.8	7971	1.5	0.8	2.1	11.1	9.5	11.5	0.32
***	Bandhan Focused	91.9	2094	1.8	0.7	5.2	14.3	11.6	12.3	0.32
***	DSP Focused	54.5	2671	1.7	0.8	0.6	11.1	9.2	10.6	0.28
***	Franklin Ind Focused Equity	98.8	11506	1.5	0.8	-9.3	6.5	9.1	11.7	0.28
***	Nippon Ind Focused	120.8	8651	1.5	1.0	-0.5	8.0	9.9	12.1	0.31
***	Sundaram Focused	164.3	1097	1.9	1.0	2.6	8.9	8.7	12.2	0.26
**	JM Focused	20.3	293	2.1	0.7	1.2	10.2	12.1	10.8	0.34
**	Mirae Asset Focused	25.2	6752	1.6	0.6	-4.1	5.9	5.3	-	0.14
**	Motilal Oswal Focused	54.1	1827	1.8	0.8	26.5	12.6	9.6	11.9	0.24
*	Axis Focused	56.1	11424	1.5	0.8	1.3	9.4	3.8	10.8	0.08
*	Baroda BNP Paribas Focused	21.0	660	2.1	0.5	-1.6	6.4	7.6	-	0.20
-	LIC MF Focused	21.9	175	2.1	1.1	1.0	7.7	7.8	-	0.23
EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS										
*****	HSBC Value	113.1	15373	1.5	0.6	3.6	14.0	15.0	14.7	0.46
*****	ICICI Pru Value	446.5	60075	1.2	0.8	-5.5	10.6	13.9	13.3	0.55
*****	Bandhan Value	144.7	9981	1.5	0.6	-1.7	8.3	11.7	13.9	0.37
*****	Nippon Ind Value	219.6	9043	1.5	0.9	-2.6	12.3	12.9	13.9	0.40
***	Aditya Birla SL Value	137.5	6925	1.6	0.9	12.7	13.1	13.7	11.1	0.37
***	JM Value	97.2	817	2.0	1.0	-0.5	10.6	14.1	14.4	0.40
***	LIC MF Value	28.7	302	2.1	0.9	19.6	15.5	12.9	-	0.35
***	Templeton India Value	674.0	1922	1.8	0.8	-5.1	7.3	12.2	12.2	0.40
***	Union Value	28.3	399	2.1	1.1	0.5	10.4	11.6	-	0.37
**	HDFC Value	784.5	8266	1.5	0.9	6.2	14.4	13.2	13.2	0.41
**	Tata Value	348.7	8656	1.5	0.7	1.1	11.3	12.5	12.9	0.40
*	Quantum Value	115.4	1122	1.8	0.9	-8.1	7.9	8.6	9.5	0.29
*	UTI Value	162.4	9573	1.5	1.0	-4.4	10.7	10.3	12.3	0.33
-	Groww Value	26.9	74	2.1	0.8	-0.5	10.8	9.7	9.2	0.31
-	Sundaram Value	206.6	1284	1.9	1.4	-6.7	5.3	7.0	9.3	0.22
EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS										
*****	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	58.5	5134	1.6	0.6	12.7	20.8	16.3	16.2	0.40
*****	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	407.1	13458	1.5	0.7	12.6	12.8	14.1	18.1	0.38
*****	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	422.8	31735	1.3	0.8	-3.3	12.6	14.1	13.1	0.47
*****	Bandhan ELSS - Tax Saver	151.7	6965	1.6	0.6	-0.4	7.6	10.4	13.5	0.33
*****	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	163.7	1414	1.8	0.8	3.2	10.5	10.1	14.8	0.38
*****	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	135.4	16666	1.4	0.7	-2.1	11.2	10.7	13.8	0.24
*****	HDFC ELSS - Tax Saver	1344.2	15992	1.4	1.0	-5.6	11.5	13.3	12.2	0.49
*****	JM ELSS - Tax Saver	52.6	248	2.1	0.9	7.7	14.4	13.3	14.9	0.40
*****	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	49.6	26428	1.4	0.6	1.0	10.5	9.8	15.1	0.31
***	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	99.1	930	2.0	0.9	3.9	13.4	10.7	12.0	0.32
***	Canara Robeco ELSS - Tax Saver	175.6	8725	1.5	0.5	0.0	9.6	8.7	13.5	0.28
***	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	114.6	462	2.1	0.7	4.7	11.4	10.3	11.5	0.32
***	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1405.5	6223	1.9	0.9	-4.3	9.2	11.1	11.4	0.34
***	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	141.7	4229	1.6	1.0	4.8	14.6	12.1	12.7	0.35
***	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	917.4	14286	1.5	1.0	-2.6	9.6	9.4	11.6	0.30
***	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	116.2	6318	1.6	0.6	0.5	9.4	10.5	12.8	0.31
***	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	128.4	14718	1.5	0.9	0.2	10.6	11.1	9.6	0.35
***	Tata ELSS - Tax Saver	46.8	4747	1.6	0.7	6.3	11.1	11.3	12.8	0.36
***	Union ELSS Tax Saver	65.3	872	2.0	1.2	-0.6	9.1	9.6	12.0	0.29
**	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	127.1	2764	1.7	0.7	0.1	11.2	9.2	12.4	0.25
**	Mah Manu ELSS Tax Saver	26.9	895	2.0	0.7	-6.5	5.7	7.7	-	0.23
**	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	34.5	722	2.0	0.8	-1.2	6.9	8.8	11.5	0.26
**	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	114.7	210	1.8	0.8	-8.0	7.8	8.6	9.6	0.29
**	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	484.3	1285	1.9	1.4	-5.5	7.0	8.7	11.4	0.28
**	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	196.9	3482	1.7	0.8	-4.5	6.5	6.4	10.7	0.18
*	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	60.8	14543	1.5	0.8	-0.5	9.8	7.4	9.7	0.22
*	Axis ELSS - Tax Saver	96.8	32667	1.3	0.7	-0.3	9.9	5.2	11.1	0.12
*	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	147.3	1021	1.9	0.9	-3.5	8.1	8.2	10.8	0.23
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	18.8	52	2.1	0.8	-6.5	7.4	7.1	-	0.19
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	20.3	48	2.1	0.7	-2.6	4.8	5.4	-	0.13
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	183.0	72	2.1	1.6	-2.3	9.2	10.1	11.9	0.33
EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS										
-	Invesco India Contra	134.1	20644	1.4	0.5	-1.3	12.9	12.1	14.3	0.37
-	Kotak Contra	151.4	5511	1.6	0.6	0.6	13.2	12.9	14.6	0.41
-	SBI Contra	371.1	47589	1.3	0.6	-2.7	9.5	14.3	14.3	0.53
EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Consumption	189.9	2452	1.7	0.6	-8.5	7.7	11.0	12.1	0.35
*****	Tata India Consumer	47.3	2901	1.7	0.6	2.7	13.0	12.3	15.2	0.38
*****	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	91.7	4742	1.6	0.4	-6.4	8.9	10.9	14.1	0.33
*****	SBI Consumption Opport	274.4	2827	1.7	0.8	-14.3	3.6	10.9	12.3	0.33
*****	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	203.2	6085	1.6	0.7	-8.6	7.0	8.3	12.1	0.25
***	Baroda BNPP India Consumption	30.1	1454	1.8	0.6	-8.5	8.2	9.0	-	0.27
***	Canara Robeco Consumption	106.0	1987	1.8	0.7	-5.3	9.0	9.8	13.7	0.30
***	ICICI Pru Bharat Consumption	24.5	3238	1.7	1.0	-6.4	8.6	12.1	-	0.42
**	Mah Manu Consumption	21.6	489	2.1	0.7	-8.0	7.9	9.5	-	0.28
**	UTI India Consumer	56.7	733	2.0	1.3	-5.4	8.8	7.9	10.2	0.23
*	Sundaram Consumption	94.4	1516	1.8	1.1	-6.8	8.1	10.2	10.7	0.31
EQUITY - THEMATIC - INFRASTRUCTURE FUNDS										
*****	BOI AXA Manufacturing & Infra	66.1	949	1.9	0.6	16.4	19.2	19.1	17.8	0.55
*****	Tata Infrastructure	41.5	3164	1.7	0.7	12.3	15.3	17.2	19.1	0.43
*****	DSP India T.I.G.E.R.	359.6	6467	1.6	0.7	14.7	18.1	20.4	16.6	0.58
*****	ICICI Pru Infrastructure	200.9	8558	1.5	1.0	4.0	16.3	21.2	16.8	0.73
*****	Invesco India Infrastructure	67.1	1548	1.8	0.8	5.3	16.8	17.6	17.1	0.49
***	Aditya Birla SL Infrastructure	107.7	1251	1.9	1.1	13.8	15.4	17.0	14.2	0.47
***	Bandhan Infrastructure	48.4	1433	1.8	0.8	-2.6	13.3	15.1	14.7	0.38
***	Canara Robeco Infrastructure	165.8	987	1.9	0.8	3.0	16.9	17.9	14.8	0.55
***	Franklin Build India	140.0	3152	1.7	0.8	-0.7	14.6	17.6	15.5	0.53
***	Kotak Infra & Economic Reform	70.6	2493	1.7	0.6	8.1	14.2	17.4	14.9	0.48
***	LIC MF Infrastructure	54.3	1174	1.9	0.7	10.0	21.2	20.2	16.1	0.55
***	Tata Infrastructure	178.7	2022	1.8	1.0	5.1	10.7	15.5	13.9	0.42
**	HSBC Infrastructure	50.8	2466	1.7	0.9	10.0	13.9	17.3	15.1	0.48
**	SBI Infrastructure	49.8	4810	1.6	0.9	3.6	12.1	15.2	14.3	0.48
**	Sundaram Infra Advantage	100.2	971	1.9	1.5	6.1	14.5	15.2	13.8	0.45
*	HDFC Infrastructure	46.7	2325	1.7	1.0	-1.3	12.7	19.1	10.5	0.56
*	UTI Infrastructure	142.7	2118	1.8	1.5	2.7	12.0	12.9	11.9	0.39
-	Taurus Infrastructure	61.5	9	2.1	1.6	-9.1	6.8	9.8	12.2	0.27
EQUITY - THEMATIC - MNC FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL MNC	1278.7	3293	1.7	1.1	-7.9	5.2	5.1	7.4	0.15
-	ICICI Pru MNC	29.8	1808	1.8	0.9	3.8	8.8	10.4	-	0.39
-	SBI MNC	410.1	6718	1.6	1.1	14.7	6.1	7.6	11.0	0.25
-	UTI MNC	394.6	2790	1.7	1.0	-2.3	7.3	7.1	9.3	0.24
EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS										
*****	Invesco India Fin Serv	145.2	1896	1.8	0.7	7.7	16.0	12.7	13.7	0.35
*****	Nippon Ind Banking & Fin Serv	639.0	7910	1.5	0.8	3.7	10.6	12.5	12.0	0.34
*****	Sundaram Fin Serv Opport	108.6	1722	1.8	0.7	8.8	11.3	12.6	12.6	0.35
*****	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	62.2	3668	1.6	0.9	4.0	8.9	9.7	10.8	0.25
*****	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	43.0	10873	1.5	0.7	1.6	14.0	11.4	13.4	0.30
*****	Tata Banking and Fin Serv	44.0	3301	1.7	0.5	4.3	10.0	10.7	12.8	0.30

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2157.8	629	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.3	6.5	6.2	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	452.9	69830	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.7	6.8	6.5	-
- Axis Liquid	3131.6	63343	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.9	6.5	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3391.7	20198	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.4	6.7	6.4	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3239.1	1825	0.1	0.1	6.7	6.7	6.9	6.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3229.2	13194	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.5	6.7	6.4	0.60
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3382.5	6783	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.5	6.8	6.4	-
- DSP Liquid	4013.4	27920	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.8	6.5	0.60
- Edelweiss Liquid	3596.4	13272	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.7	6.9	6.5	-
- Groww Liquid	2717.4	381	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- HDFC Liquid	5512.7	71323	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- HSBC Liquid	2801.3	20975	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	415.8	62798	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3864.0	20748	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.7	6.9	6.5	-
- ITI Liquid	1459.2	52	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.1	6.3	6.1	-
- JM Liquid	76.6	1743	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- Kotak Liquid	5677.8	49073	0.3	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5079.3	17484	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1829.1	1392	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.7	6.8	6.4	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2944.4	17359	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.5	6.7	6.3	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.8	1015	0.4	0.2	5.7	6.0	6.2	5.9	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.3	1015	-	0.2	5.9	6.3	6.4	6.2	-
- Navi Liquid	30.4	74	0.3	0.2	5.4	5.7	5.9	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6858.7	43125	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1557.8	6722	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.5	6.8	6.4	-
- PGIM India Liquid	365.9	1031	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- Quant Liquid	44.2	1426	0.5	0.3	5.8	5.9	5.9	5.8	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.4	556	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.0	6.0	5.9	-
- SBI Liquid	4390.6	92192	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2477.0	9094	0.3	0.1	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.4	-
- Tata Liquid	4425.8	32370	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.5	6.8	6.4	-
- TRUSTMF Liquid	1364.1	1203	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.5	6.7	6.3	-
- Union Liquid	2704.0	7578	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.8	6.4	-
- UTI Liquid	461.2	29218	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.9	6.5	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1509.7	743	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.7	6.3	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1476.9	10464	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1453.3	11325	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.2	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1457.7	1160	0.1	0.0	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1397.9	109	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.6	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1440.6	852	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1420.8	737	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- DSP Overnight	1467.0	2854	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1420.0	192	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1432.5	685	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.2	5.3	-
- Groww Overnight	1409.4	12	0.2	0.1	4.6	4.8	5.0	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	4040.6	12190	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1429.4	4535	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1475.3	14368	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1387.2	343	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- ITI Overnight	1383.5	14	0.2	0.1	4.4	4.7	4.8	4.9	-
- JM Overnight	1388.8	148	0.1	0.1	4.6	4.8	4.9	5.0	-
- Kotak Overnight	1459.9	8618	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1416.5	732	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1415.9	77	0.1	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1404.3	1727	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	147.0	8548	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1413.4	153	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- SBI Overnight	4418.7	23407	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1452.7	1335	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.1	-
- Tata Overnight	1442.6	4571	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1439.8	411	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3729.3	5648	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.4	27237	0.9	0.3	4.0	5.8	5.5	5.9	-
- Axis Arbitrage	20.0	10594	0.9	0.3	4.0	5.7	5.5	5.9	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.6	7796	0.9	0.3	3.9	5.5	5.3	5.7	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.7	134	0.9	0.4	4.5	5.3	5.1	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.1	1055	1.0	0.3	3.6	5.2	5.1	5.5	-
- DSP Arbitrage	16.0	6673	0.8	0.3	3.6	5.5	5.4	5.8	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.7	14849	0.9	0.3	3.9	5.7	5.6	5.9	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.8	25509	0.8	0.3	4.0	5.7	5.6	6.0	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.3	3288	0.8	0.2	2.6	5.6	5.5	5.9	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.8	34850	0.8	0.3	4.2	6.0	5.6	6.0	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	34.2	30618	0.9	0.3	4.1	5.8	5.6	6.1	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.8	63	0.8	0.2	3.7	4.5	4.7	5.6	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.8	482	0.9	0.4	3.6	5.2	5.1	5.6	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	40.1	75712	0.8	0.3	4.1	5.8	5.7	6.0	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.8	310	0.7	0.2	5.8	5.7	5.8	5.9	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.1	134	1.0	0.3	4.0	4.8	4.8	5.4	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.9	3838	0.8	0.1	3.4	5.5	5.3	5.8	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.4	17533	0.9	0.3	4.0	5.7	5.5	5.9	-
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.6	99	0.9	0.3	4.5	5.3	5.4	5.7	-
- SBI Arbitrage	36.2	47283	0.8	0.3	4.0	5.5	5.5	5.9	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.4	554	0.8	0.2	4.0	5.2	5.5	5.9	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.4	24950	0.9	0.3	4.2	5.7	5.5	5.9	-
- Union Arbitrage	15.0	221	0.9	0.3	5.1	6.1	5.8	5.9	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.5	11132	0.8	0.3	3.7	5.8	5.5	6.0	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TERM FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short Term	591.7	18819	0.5	0.3	6.5	7.2	7.3	6.5	9.15
***** Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Term	1663.2	666	0.4	0.2	6.5	7.0	7.1	6.5	-
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short-Term	1411.1	2066	0.4	0.2	6.5	7.0	7.2	6.4	11.75
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Term	16.4	4180	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
***** HSBC Ultra Short Term	1459.7	3628	0.3	0.1	6.5	6.9	7.0	6.3	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.8	15974	0.7	0.3	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.3	8.04
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Term	4333.4	12447	0.9	0.3	6.3	6.7	6.8	6.2	19.81
*** Axis Ultra Short Term	15.8	6074	1.1	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.6	5.9	10.15
*** DSP Ultra Short Term	3652.9	4599	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.7	5.9	6.54
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.3	17465	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.2	9.03
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Term	2900.7	1497	0.7	0.2	6.3	6.8	6.9	6.1	4.68
*** Kotak Ultra Short Term	46.1	15962	0.7	0.3	6.1	6.7	6.8	6.1	7.15
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Term	1480.0	222	0.6	0.3	6.3	6.8	6.9	6.1	2.03
*** SBI Ultra Short Term	6431.3	11880	0.5	0.3	6.3	6.8	7.0	6.2	10.96
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	15.2	6495	1.0	0.3	6.2	6.6	6.6	5.9	9.97
*** UTI Ultra Short Term	4549.2	3348	0.9	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.7	6.6	11.61
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Term	1458.5	584	0.7	0.2	5.9	6.4	6.5	5.9	-
*** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3390.9	184	0.9	0.4	6.1	6.4	6.4	5.8	-
*** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4072.3	582	0.8	0.3	6.0	6.4	6.5	5.7	-
*** LIC MF Ultra Short Term	1414.7	678	1.2	0.2	5.8	6.3	6.4	5.7	2.26
*** PGIM India Ultra Short Term	36.4	211	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.8	-
*** ITI Ultra Short Term	1321.6	165	0.8	0.2	5.8	6.1	6.3	5.5	-
*** Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.5	524	1.0	0.2	5.4	5.5	5.7	5.1	-
*** Sundaram Ultra Short Term	2859.5	2416	1.3	0.2	5.4	5.9	6.0	5.3	1.28

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TO SHORT TERM FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short to Short Term	586.9	21047	0.5	0.4	6.4	7.2	7.4	6.6	6.09
***** UTI Ultra Short to Short Term	3821.0	2680	0.4	0.3	6.3	7.1	7.2	7.4	7.12

bl rating	SchemeName	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
*****	Axis Ultra Short to Short Term	3328.8	4558	0.6	0.3	6.1	7.0	7.1	6.3	7.59
*****	Bandhan Ultra Short to Short Term	41.4	6404	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
*****	HDFC Ultra Short to Short Term	61.9	17793	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.7	6.8	6.1	11.75
*****	HSBC Ultra Short to Short Term	30.8	875	0.8	0.3	6.1	7.5	7.4	6.4	7.56
****	Aditya Birla SL Ult Shrt to Shrt Term	701.2	9727	1.0	0.4	5.5	6.4	6.6	5.9	7.94
***	Canara Robeco Ult Shrt to Shrt Term	45.3	1111	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
***	DSP Ultra Short to Short Term	21.3	4750	0.5	0.3	5.9	6.7	6.8	6.1	-
***	Invesco India Ultra Shrt to Shrt Term	4059.0	1833	0.5	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	7.20
*****	JM Ultra Short to Short Term	39.7	215	0.7	0.3	5.8	6.7	6.8	6.0	3.48
***	Mirae Asset Ultra Shrt to Shrt Term	2420.8	2434	0.7	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.8	5.9	6.15
***	Nippon Ind Ultra Short to Shrt Term	4017.8	7933	0.8	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	5.09
***	Tata Ultra Short to Short Term	4226.9	2871	0.5	0.2	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.2	4.04
**	Kotak Ultra Short to Short Term	3578.5	12093	1.0	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.7	5.9	8.77
**	LIC MF Ultra Short to Short Term	42.4	2010	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.7	5.9	5.21
***	Mahi Manu Ultra Short to Short Term	1750.6	535	0.9	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.7	5.8	12.86
***	SBI Ultra Short to Short Term	3735.7	11622	0.8	0.4	5.6	6.5	6.7	5.9	4.62
**	Baroda BNPP Ult Shrt to Shrt Term	42.9	382	0.9	0.2	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.8	-
*	Sundaram Ultra Short to Short Term	3691.4	446	1.0	0.3	5.4	6.3	6.6	5.8	1.42

‘For F&O trades, investors will move to institutional products’

GAINING GROUND. NSE expects revenue to diversify beyond index options

Our Bureau
Chennai

As the Union government takes steps to clamp down on retail F&O trading, IPO-bound NSE, which generates roughly two-thirds of its revenue from the segment, believes investors will, over the long term, move away from speculative bets to specialised institutional products.

Speaking at a press event here on Saturday, Sriram Krishnan, NSE’s Chief Business Development Officer (CBDO), said SEBI will gradually encourage investors to take the SIF route for F&O exposure instead of trading directly and “burning their fingers”.

SIF, or Specialised Investment Fund, is an investment category introduced by the regulator that allows investors to participate in advanced market instruments such as derivatives. These funds require a minimum investment of



LONG-TERM STRATEGY. Sriram Krishnan (left), Chief Business Development Officer, NSE and Ian Desouza, Chief Financial Officer at a press conference in Chennai

₹10 lakh. Krishnan said that just as the mutual fund industry brought trust and protection to the cash equity segment, SIFs could do the same for F&O.

“SEBI has been prioritising long-term investor education and awareness. So, currently you may see a situation where a lot of people are directly trading F&O. But it is possible that in the future there may be a gradual shift and people may move towards institu-

tional products to gain F&O exposure. Which may be a good thing,” he said.

Commenting on NSE’s long-term strategy, Krishnan said the exchange will continue to introduce innovative products, citing electronic gold receipts (EGRs) and electricity futures as examples. “In the longer term, there will be so much diversification of revenue as a natural consequence. People will forget this current focus on index

options,” he said.

NSE is gearing up for a ₹22,569-crore (upper band) public debut next week through a pure offer for sale (OFS). The Mumbai-based exchange had initially proposed an issue size of around ₹30,000 crore in its draft papers, but later trimmed it by 15 per cent.

INVESTOR INTEREST

Krishnan said that when NSE initially gauged investor interest in the IPO, around 6 per cent of the stake was available for participation.

“However, some of the shareholders feel that the NSE stock price is much more than what we are proposing to do the IPO at. So some of them have backed out of the OFS saying that they don’t want to tender their shares any more,” he said.

Meanwhile, NSE expects the number of companies listed on its platform to nearly double to around 6,000 over the next decade.

After 2 years, Chennai airport’s passenger plaza to open today

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai



After nearly two years of delay, the passenger pick-up plaza at the Chennai Airport will be inaugurated on Sunday, with Civil Aviation Minister K Ram Mohan Naidu set to open the facility virtually. The virtual inauguration is due to the ongoing BRICS Summit, a statement said.

This will be a major relief for passengers arriving from both domestic and international destinations who had to travel in golf carts to reach the taxi pick-up points.

The ₹23-crore plaza will provide passengers with a pick-up point directly opposite the T1 domestic terminal, allowing them to board cabs without having to make the long trek to the multi-level car parking facility. The existing pick-up point at the airport complex will also continue to operate, sources said.

For passengers, particularly those arriving on in-

ternational flights with large amounts of baggage, the new facility is expected to be a significant relief.

FACILITIES

Initially the plaza will accommodate cab aggregators including Uber, Ola, Rapido, Fast Track, Red Taxi, WTI and pre-paid taxi. The facility will be extended to other yellow board vehicles in future, once the new system is streamlined, said airport sources.

The plaza has a seating capacity of 150 passengers and is equipped with covered roofing, drinking water facilities, Flight Information Display System (FIDS) and other passenger amenities.

Former RBI Governor Subbarao makes a case for fee on some UPI transactions

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

Former Reserve Bank of India Governor D Subbarao has made a case for introducing charges on some Unified Payments Interface transactions, arguing that although UPI is free to its users, operating the system involves costs that must ultimately be borne by someone.

While acknowledging the powerful argument that levying charges might

force millions of informal and unorganised sector participants to exit and return to cash, he argued that leaving transactions free would discourage banks from innovating and maintaining systems.

DISTRIBUTED BURDEN

“I believe that we should charge for them, because the user should pay,” he said.

He pointed out that if users do not pay, banks will distribute the burden across all customers. He

said the government could adopt a calibrated approach, beginning with charges on high-value transactions before considering wider application.

Speaking at the launch of the book *Cashless Nation*, authored by Santanu Paul and B. Sambamurthy, Subbarao said UPI has narrowed the gender gap, it has not closed it.

He said that even when women have access to mobile phones, they often lack the privacy, confidence, or agency to use the platform.

thehindu**businessline.**
Classifieds
RENTAL
COMMERCIAL

4900 SQ FT VACANT LAND Close Proximity To ECR Very Near To Mahablipuram Offered For Rental Built To Suit Commercial Space Users. Ideal For Quick Commerce Dark Store /Supply Chain Godown / Ware House For Corporates & We Welcome Any Other Business Proposals Also. Owner Viswanathan 9841067515

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
Toll Free: **1800 102 4161**



Share your feedback on
bl.portfolio



Whatsapp on: 73583 71111



Scan the code

bl.portfolio

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FORM A (Under Regulation 6 of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (Insolvency Resolution Process for Corporate Persons) Regulations, 2016) FOR THE ATTENTION OF THE CREDITORS OF M/s. AKS COLD STORAGE LIMITED		
RELEVANT PARTICULARS		
1	Name of corporate debtor	M/s. Aks Cold Storage Limited
2	Date of incorporation of corporate debtor	09th January 2003
3	Authority under which corporate debtor is incorporated/registered	Registrar of Companies, Kerala.
4	Corporate Identity No. / Limited Liability Identification No. of corporate debtor	U63022KL2003PLC015881
5	Address of the registered office and principal office (if any) of corporate debtor	SF No. 43 1 G2, Aroor Junction, Aroor Post, Alappuzha, Kerala - 688534
6	Insolvency commencement date in respect of corporate debtor	Order No.C.P. (IB)/19/KOB/2026 dated 10th September, 2026
7	Estimated date of closure of insolvency resolution process	09th March, 2027
8	Name and registration number of the insolvency professional acting as interim resolution professional	CA. Mahalingam Suresh Kumar Designated Partner and Authorized Signatory M/s. SPP Insolvency Professionals LLP, 2nd Floor, CODISSIA, G.D. Naidu Towers, Huzur Road, Coimbatore - 641 018 IBBI Reg No. IBBI/1PE-0143/IPA-1/2022-23/50033 Ph.no: +91 94888 10404/ +91 73730 52341 Mail to: akscsltdcirp@gmail.com / msureshkumar@icai.org
9	Address and e-mail of the interim resolution professional, as registered with the Board	
10	Address and e-mail to be used for correspondence with the interim resolution professional	
11	Last date for submission of claims	24th September, 2026
12	Classes of creditors, if any, under clause (b) of sub-section (6A) of section 21, ascertained by the interim resolution professional	Not Applicable
13	Names of Insolvency Professionals identified to act as Authorised Representative of creditors in a class (Three names for each class)	
14	(a) Relevant Forms and (b) Details of authorized representatives are available at:	
Notice is hereby given that the National Company Law Tribunal has ordered the commencement of a corporate insolvency resolution process of M/s. Aks Cold Storage Limited on 10th September, 2026. The creditors of M/s. Aks Cold Storage Limited are hereby called upon to submit their claims with proof on or before 24th September, 2026 to the interim resolution professional at the address mentioned against entry No.10. The financial creditors shall submit their claims with proof by electronic means only. All other creditors may submit the claims with proof in person, by post or by electronic means. A financial creditor belonging to a class, as listed against the entry No. 12, shall indicate its choice of authorized representative from among the three insolvency professionals listed against entry No.13 to act as authorized representative of the classin Form CA. Submission of false or misleading proofs of claim shall attract penalties. Date : 11.09.2026 Place : Coimbatore CA. Mahalingam Suresh Kumar Designated Partner and Authorized Signatory M/s. SPP Insolvency Professionals LLP [IPE] acting as IRP of M/s. Aks Cold Storage Limited IBBI Reg No. IBBI/1PE-0143/IPA-1/2022-23/50033 AFA No.: AA1/50033/02/300627/20098 valid up to 30.06.2027		



CELEBRATING THE QUIET DREAMERS WHO DRIVE POWERFUL CHANGE.



They are the visionaries who dream quietly and act with intent. Their steady pursuit of progress turns belief into action, and action into a future we can all look forward to.

The Hindu businessline Changemaker Awards 2026 celebrates these leaders of change, recognising the ones who challenge the ordinary and set in motion ripples that transform lives and communities.

Join us live as we applaud the changemakers shaping tomorrow.



CHIEF GUEST
Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman
Honourable Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs, Government of India



Scan the QR code or visit thbl.news/BLCM2026 to subscribe and watch the event.



Presents

thehindu**businessline.**



**CHANGE
MAKER
awards** RECOGNISING
HUMAN
CATALYSTS

Powered by



September 22 | 6 pm onwards | New Delhi

Presenting Partner



Powered by



Associate Partners



Mobility Partner



A CH-CHE

QUICKLY.

‘UNSC reforms can no longer wait’

Iran President’s daughter visits BRICS Bazaar



New Delhi: Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian’s daughter Zahra Pezeshkian visited the Pradhanmantri Sangrahalaya (Prime Minister’s Museum) and the BRICS Bazaar here on Saturday. After Pezeshkian visited the BRICS Bazaar, Union Minister Annpurna Devi posted on X, “Had the opportunity to show them around the Bazaar and share the rich traditions, art, crafts and cultural heritage showcased by BRICS member and partner nations.”^{PTI}

PM greets leaders against TN temple backdrop

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday welcomed BRICS leaders against a backdrop featuring Tamil Nadu’s iconic Ramanathaswamy temple, one of the four shrines where Lord Rama is believed to have performed puja after his victory over demon king Ravana. Welcoming Xi, Modi also explained to him the significance of the temple. ^{PTI}

India pushes for Working Group on Sports Tech

New Delhi: Describing sport as a vehicle for social development, the BRICS New Delhi Declaration on Saturday backed India’s proposals of forming a Working Group on Sports Technology and the organisation of a Sports Goods Manufacturing Conclave for enhanced cooperation among member nations. The working group on sports technology and the conclave for sports goods manufacturers were among the three key initiatives that Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya listed during the BRICS Sports Ministers’ meet in Visakhapatnam last month. ^{PTI}

‘Sangam’ mural displayed at BRICS summit venue



New Delhi: Inspired by the Indian concept of ‘Sangam’ — meeting of rivers — artists from member countries of BRICS have come together to create a large-scale thematic mural at the Summit venue, symbolising friendship and a confluence of cultures. It was created under the theme “Sangam: Confluence of Cultures” and brings together the diverse artistic traditions of the BRICS member countries. ICCR helmed the project. ^{PTI}

Grain Exchange finds place in Delhi Declaration

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Recognising member countries’ key roles in world food production, the Russian proposal to set up a BRICS Grain Exchange found mention in the New Delhi Declaration. It welcomed further discussions on the modalities of its functioning. Russia is keen to see the BRICS Grain Exchange start on a pilot basis this year and full fledged operation in 2027, sources said. “We emphasise the importance of ensuring food security nutrition and mitigating the impacts of acute food price volatility, as well as abrupt supply crises, including fertilizers shortage. In this regard, we acknowledge the importance of continued elaboration of the initiative to establish a grain trading platform within BRICS (the BRICS Grain Exchange) and welcome further discussions on the modalities of its func-

‘UNSC reforms can no longer wait’

PARTNERSHIP PLATFORM. At BRICS Summit, PM outlines 10 proposals to end the ‘Pyramid of Privilege’

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday officially declared the BRICS Summit, 2026 open with ten proposals to upend the global “pyramid of privilege” for a select few countries into a “platform of partnership” for everyone. He asserted that the reforms in the UN Security Council can no longer be delayed. Exhorting the gathering that included the top leadership of BRICS — Russian President Vladimir Putin, Chinese Premier Xi Jinping, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, South African President Cyril Ramaphosa, Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto — to steer the Global South towards becoming a “rule shaper” to deal with various challenges, PM Modi hoped that the two-day annual BRICS summit will deliberate on protecting developing economies from the global impact of wars in Ukraine and West Asia. The other leaders attending the summit are Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Ethiopian Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed Ali, Egyptian President Abdel Fattah El-Sisi and Vietnamese Prime Minister Le Minh Hung. PM Modi also called for immediate reform of the UN Security Coun-



RULE SHAPER. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President Vladimir Putin, and BRICS leaders visit the Bharat Innovates exhibition at the 18th BRICS Summit 2026, in New Delhi on Saturday^{ANI}

cil. “The UNSC reforms can no longer wait,” he said. **REFORM ROADMAP** He called for a major overhaul of global governance, proposing that the eleven-member BRICS bloc prepare a “10-point Reform Roadmap” to make international institutions more representative, responsive and inclusive, with countries driving global economic growth given a greater role in shaping global rules. “Those countries that give momentum to global economic growth should also get due role in giving direction to global economic governance,” the PM said. Efforts need to be made to make the Global South move from being rule-takers to rule-shapers, Modi said. “Through BRICS, we can provide

negotiation skills, practical training, and legal expertise to young diplomats and policy-makers of Global South countries,” he added. Modi said the current global governance structure resembled a “pyramid”, with power and decision-making concentrated at the top while countries affected by these decisions remained largely at the bottom. “The Global South is at the front row of global crises, but at the back row of decision-making,” he said, calling for the pyramid to be transformed into a “privileged platform of partnership” where every country has a voice and every member has a stake. Modi proposed that BRICS jointly prepare ten proposals for global governance reform and give them the form of a ‘BRICS Reform Roadmap’ by the next summit. He

Modi, Abu Dhabi Crown Prince discuss expanding India-UAE ties

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on Saturday, with the two leaders reviewing the growing India-UAE partnership and identifying defence, space, nuclear energy, technology and innovation as areas for further cooperation. The meeting comes amid an intensification of high-level political engagement between New Delhi and Abu Dhabi. The leaders recalled the visit of UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan to India in January and Modi’s visit to the UAE in May, underlining the regular leadership-level contact that has become a defining feature of the relationship. The two sides also welcomed the UAE’s “active and constructive” participation in BRICS under India’s chairship and agreed to continue working closely within the grouping to advance shared interests and strengthen cooperation. **INVESTMENTS FOCUS** A significant focus of Saturday’s talks was investment. “The leaders acknowledged the progress achieved in bilateral relations in a wide range of sectors. They positively noted the announcement by the UAE’s International Holding Company to invest in the development of \$11.5 billion integrated greenfield aluminium project in Odisha, India’s largest integrated aluminium investment. The project is expected to position Odisha as a



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with UAE leader Sheikh Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan. PRIME MINISTER’S OFFICE VIA AP

global aluminium manufacturing hub,” said an MEA statement following the meeting. The two leaders also discussed the role of L’Imad, the UAE’s newest sovereign investment fund, in deepening investment flows between the two countries, besides cooperation in strategic and emerging technologies. **GROWING CLOSENESS** The meeting is the latest in a series of high-level engagements involving Sheikh Khaled, who has emerged as an important interlocutor for India in its relationship with Abu Dhabi. His first official visit to India as Crown Prince, in September 2024, resulted in agreements spanning nuclear energy, LNG and other strategic sectors. The visit was also significant because it was the first by Sheikh Khaled to India in his capacity as Crown Prince. Sheikh Khaled returned to New Delhi in February 2026 to participate in the AI Impact Summit, his second official visit to India. The political relationship was elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2017, during the visit of Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed, then Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, to India as chief guest for the Republic Day

celebrations. Modi’s relationship with the UAE leadership has since been marked by unusually frequent high-level contact. During his 2018 UAE visit, he met both Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed and Dubai’s ruler Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, with the MEA describing the UAE as a valued strategic partner with fast-tracked cooperation in the economy, energy, high technology and security. The personal equation between Modi and the Abu Dhabi leadership was further underscored during his 2019 visit, when Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed conferred the Order of Zayed, the UAE’s highest civilian honour, on the Prime Minister. The relationship has subsequently acquired a strong economic architecture. The two countries signed a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) in 2022 and a Local Currency Settlement mechanism in 2023 to facilitate cross-border transactions in the Indian rupee and UAE dirham. The UAE has also become one of India’s major trading and investment partners, while its roughly 3.5-million-strong Indian community remains a major anchor of bilateral ties. Modi’s February 2024 UAE visit further broadened the relationship, with agreements covering investment, the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, digital infrastructure and the nuclear sector. He also inaugurated the BAPS Hindu Mandir in Abu Dhabi, which the MEA has since described as a cultural symbol. The momentum has continued into 2026. During Modi’s May visit to the UAE, India and Abu Dhabi advanced cooperation in areas including strategic petroleum reserves and energy.

Modi hails Ethiopia’s BRICS role

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Ethiopian Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed Ali met in New Delhi on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit on Saturday, focusing their talks on strengthening economic cooperation, capacity building, and defence and security partnerships. “The two leaders held discussions aimed at further strengthening the bilateral strategic partnership. They reviewed progress across key sectors, including economic cooperation, defence and security partnership, and capacity building,” per a statement issued by the MEA. The meeting built directly upon Prime Minister Modi’s visit to Addis Ababa in December 2025. “PM Modi... noted that its presence at the Summit helped reinforce the collective voice of the Global South,” said the statement.

Modi, Vietnam PM review ties after strategic partnership upgrade

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi met his Vietnamese counterpart Le Minh Hung on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on Saturday, reviewing the progress in bilateral ties after India and Vietnam upgraded their relationship to an Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership earlier this year. Modi welcomed Vietnam’s participation in the BRICS Summit as a partner country and the two leaders exchanged views on regional and global issues of mutual interest, according to the Ministry of External Affairs. They reaffirmed their commitment to further strengthening the partnership. **MUTUAL IMPORTANCE** “The meeting provided an opportunity for both leaders to review the progress made in bilateral ties, which were elevated to an Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership during the State Visit of To Lam, General Secretary of the Communist Party of Vietnam and President of the Socialist Republic of Vietnam, to India in May. Both leaders

identified three key areas for the roadmap — representation, responsiveness and rule-making. On representation, Modi said reform of the United Nations Security Council could no longer be stalled and called for text-based negotiations to be linked to a definite timeline and clear outcome. He also called for the voting power, leadership positions and policy priorities of international financial institutions to be reviewed in line with today’s economic realities. On responsiveness, Modi said the credibility of global institutions would depend on their ability to provide effective solutions with greater speed, scale and last-mile impact. He proposed a ‘Seafarer Emergency Support Network’ connecting maritime authorities and diplomatic missions to support seafarers caught in crises. Modi also sought to ensure that the grouping maintains institutional momentum over the long term despite changes in its agenda from year to year. He proposed a ‘BRICS Continuity and Implementation Mechanism’, under which the grouping’s Troika would follow up on initiatives and outcomes. A secure digital repository, he said, could record every decision to track commitments across successive BRICS presidencies.

Modi, Malaysian PM discuss chips, defence and trade



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with his Malaysian counterpart Anwar Ibrahim. PMO

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Malaysian Prime Minister Dato Seri Anwar bin Ibrahim held a bilateral meeting in New Delhi on Saturday, focussing on a wide range of areas, according to the Ministry of External Affairs. “The leaders took stock of the outcomes of PM Modi’s visit to Malaysia in February and reviewed the progress in bilateral cooperation across a range of areas, including trade and investment, defence and security, semiconductors, infrastructure, digital economy, energy, fintech, education, tourism and people-to-people ties,” per an MEA statement. Anwar Ibrahim conveyed Malaysia’s concurrence for the establishment of a Consulate General of India in Kota Kinabalu, Sabah. Modi appreciated Malaysia’s continued support in strengthening ASEAN-India relations. “...They expressed continued commitment to advancing India-Malaysia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership,” the statement added.

BRICS voices ‘deep concern’ on Gaza violence, Gulf crisis

Our Bureau
New Delhi



While avoiding condemnation of Israel by name, it catalogues violations that squarely implicate Israeli conduct in Gaza and the Occupied Palestinian Territory. ^{PTI}

The New Delhi Declaration adopted at the XVIII BRICS Summit on Saturday steers a stern diplomatic line on West Asia, expressing alarm, demanding restraint, and reaffirming positions on Palestine, Lebanon and Syria. While carefully avoiding direct condemnation of Israel by name, it catalogues violations that squarely implicate Israeli conduct in Gaza and the Occupied Palestinian Territory. The Declaration expresses “deep concern” on the situation in Cuba due to tightening of “unilateral blockade measures”, although it does not name the US, and reiterates the necessity of ending the economic, commercial and financial measures against Cuba in accordance with the UNGA resolution. The Declaration expresses “deep concern over the continued escalation of tensions in Middle East/West Asia” and called for “exercising maximum restraint,” urging protection of civilians and civilian infrastructure “in accordance with the purposes and principles of the Charter of the United Nations.” On Gaza specifically, the bloc expresses deep concern on the continued violence despite the ceasefire agreement of October 2025. “We call for the implementation of the relevant UNGA and UNSC resolutions and urge all parties to ensure the maintenance of ceasefire and full and unhindered humanitarian access in the Gaza Strip. In this context, we express deep concern on the continued violence in Gaza despite the ceasefire agreement of October 2025. We call for halting any policies aimed at forced displacement of Palestinians from Gaza Strip and express concern regarding arrangements that may prejudice the inalienable rights of the Palestinian people and legitimize or prolong occupation,” the declaration says.

CONDEMNS EXCESSES The Declaration condemns violations of international humanitarian law “including the use of starvation as a method of warfare, attacks targeting civilians and civilian objects, including healthcare facilities,” and the “unlawful obstruction of humanitarian access”. These are excesses widely attributed to the Israeli military in rights groups’ and UN reporting, though the text itself remained agent-neutral, using passive constructions throughout. “We reiterate our grave concern about the situation in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including the humanitarian situation in Gaza. We call for adherence

to international law, in particular to international humanitarian law and international human rights law, and condemn all their violations, including the use of starvation as a method of warfare, attacks targeting civilians and civilian objects, including healthcare facilities and other civilian infrastructure, as well as the unlawful obstruction of humanitarian access. We also condemn attempts to politicise or militarize humanitarian assistance,” it says. The Declaration also notes the International Court of Justice’s provisional measures in the case brought by South Africa against Israel, which “reaffirmed Israel’s legal obligation to ensure the provision of humanitarian aid in Gaza.” On the broader Palestinian question, the bloc reaffirms support for Palestine’s full UN membership “in the context of the unwavering commitment to the two-state solution,” anchored to the 1967 borders “which included the Gaza Strip and the West Bank, with East Jerusalem as its capital.” It rejects “any unilateral measures that seek to alter the legal and historical status of occupied Jerusalem” and expresses “firm opposition to the forced displacement, temporary or permanent, under any pretext” of Palestinians from occupied territory.

WELCOMES CEASEFIRE On Lebanon, the Declaration welcomes the ceasefire and calls on “all parties to strictly adhere to its terms,” but directs its sharpest language at Israel by name: it calls “on Israel to respect the terms agreed with the Lebanese government and to withdraw its occupying forces from all of the Lebanese territories, in which they remain.” The bloc also condemns attacks on UNIFIL installations and personnel, extending condolences for the deaths of four Indonesian peacekeepers and other casualties. On Syria, the declaration backs “an inclusive Syrian-led and Syrian-owned, UN facilitated political process, free from foreign interference,” while pressing Damascus to act against terrorism.

No BRICS currency for now, clarifies MEA

Our Bureau
New Delhi

BRICS countries are not discussing a common currency ‘as of now’, the External Affairs Ministry said on Saturday. But BRICS Payment Task Force will continue exploring ways for cross-border payment among member countries. “There is no proposal for a BRICS currency as of now,” Sudhakar Dalela, Secretary (Economic Relations), MEA, said in a press conference here. In fact, the Joint Declaration did not mention such a common currency or a formal call for replacement of the US dollar. Rather the document sticks to the more incremental, technocratic language the bloc has used since Rio and Kazan: interoperable payment systems, local-currency settlement and voluntary cooperation among members who ‘respect national priorities.’

Dalela said that discussion on trade settlement in local currency has been underway for some time.

LOCAL CURRENCY “We believe local currency settlement is a practical mechanism to reduce transaction cost to in bilateral trade, and this has been encouraged as a complementary to global payment settlement system, improving overall global trade across nations,” he said. Earlier, the joint declaration acknowledged the efforts of the BPTF towards exploring pragmatic solutions.

businessline.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.